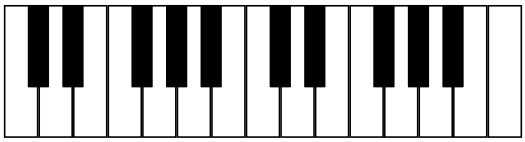
Read at Sight

A graded sight-reading course for piano

Volume 6 - Reading Like a Professional



Middle C

Three voices, cross-rhythms, changing meters and chromatic harmony; songs on three staves, open score with C clefs, lead sheets, and transposing and simplifying at sight.

Exercises generated to graded rules; pieces are original or public domain.

How to use this book

What is new in Volume 6

Volumes 1-5 taught you to read piano music. This volume teaches you to read music written for anyone: three-voice counterpoint, two rhythms at once, meters that change bar by bar, chromatic harmony, big textures, a singer's line above the piano, open score with alto and tenor clefs, and lead sheets with chord symbols. It also teaches the professional's two survival skills: simplifying at sight (dropping notes without losing the music) and transposing at sight. Start this book when you have passed the Volume 5 checkpoint: every key, triplets, the pedal, clef changes and ornaments.

The five rules

1. Never stop: keep the beat going, even after a wrong note. 2. Count out loud and use a metronome at the speed shown. 3. Keep your eyes on the music, not your hands. 4. Read the shape: up, down, or the same, and by how much. 5. Play each exercise once, tick its box, and move on. Come back only after a few weeks.

Before every exercise: 10 seconds

Name the key (or mode) and the time signature, and check whether either changes. Count the staves and name each clef. Find the hardest bar and decide what you will drop from it if you must. Then count one bar in and play.

How each unit is laid out

A unit opens with what is new, short examples, and reading tips. Parts A to C are generated exercises that practise the new idea. The pieces come next: real music by the great composers, chosen because each needs exactly the unit's new skill. A checkpoint ends the unit.

A daily routine (15-20 minutes)

Warm up with the scale and the main chords of the day's key (2 minutes). Read 4-6 new exercises, one pass each (8 minutes). Then read one piece, or a page of one, keeping the beat and simplifying where you must (8 minutes).

Contents

Each unit adds exactly one new idea to everything before it.

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Chord symbols (C, Am7, G7/B, Fmaj7, Bdim, C/E); playing from a lead sheet; review

Unit 1

Three Voices

New: Three independent voices on two staves; the middle voice passes between the hands; fugue entries

Volumes 1-5 taught you to read piano music. This volume teaches you to read music written for anyone: for three or four independent voices, for a singer and a pianist, for a string quartet, for a band reading from chord symbols. It starts with the hardest kind of piano music to read at sight: three voices at once, as in a Bach sinfonia or fugue.

In three-voice music the right hand usually plays two voices on the upper staff and the left hand plays the bass. But the middle voice goes where it likes: when it comes down, the left hand takes it, and when it goes up, the right hand takes it back. Read each voice as a line, not as a pile of chords.

What is new

Three voices

Two voices share the upper staff: the top one has stems up, the middle one stems down. The bass is alone on the lower staff. Follow each line by its stems and beams; a note held in one voice goes on while another voice moves.

The middle voice changes hands

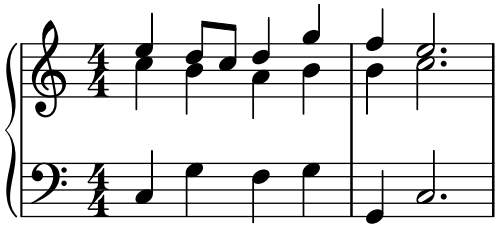
When the middle voice comes down near the bass, it is printed on the lower staff (stems up) and the left hand plays it. Look for a run of notes that moves from one staff to the other: it is one line.

Subject, answer, countersubject

A fugue starts with one voice alone playing a short tune: the subject. Then a second voice plays it a fifth higher (or a fourth lower): the answer, while the first voice goes on with a counter-tune, the countersubject. Then the third voice plays the subject again. Once you know the subject, you can read every entry at a glance.

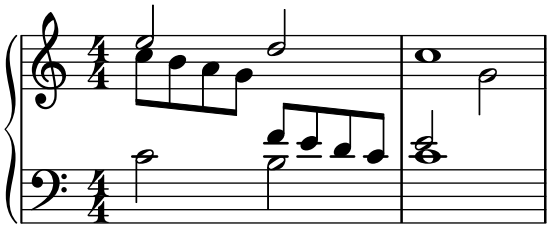
Three voices on two staves

Top voice: stems up. Middle voice: stems down on the same staff. Bass: the lower staff. The top voice moves while the middle one holds, and the other way round.



The middle voice changes hands

The middle voice runs down from the right hand into the left hand (stems up on the lower staff) and comes back up in bar 2. It is one line: play it smoothly across the hands.



A subject and its answer

The subject of the Fugue in G (the last piece in this unit), then the answer a fourth lower. A real answer moves every note by the same distance. This one is a tonal answer: the subject's first note, D (the fifth of G), is answered by G (the tonic), not by A; after that the answer is exact.



Reading tips

1. Before you play, follow each voice through the first two bars with your eyes: top, middle, bass.

2. Stems tell you the voice: on the upper staff, stems up are the top voice and stems down the middle voice.

3. When notes jump from one staff to the other in a beamed group, it is the middle voice changing hands.

4. In a fugue, learn the subject by heart before you start: every new entry is the same tune.

5. Keep held notes held. If a held note is hard, shorten it rather than stop the beat.

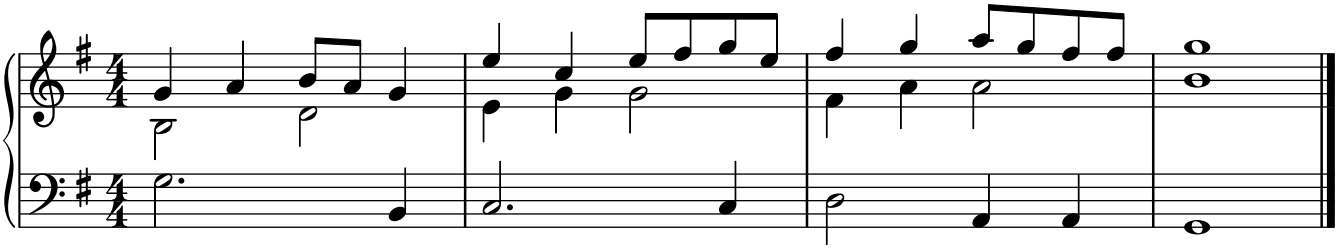
Part A: Three voices: two in the right hand ♩= 60

Three voices: the right hand plays a tune and a middle voice on the upper staff, the left hand a bass. Four bars. C, G, F major and D minor.

☐ **1.1**



☐ **1.2**



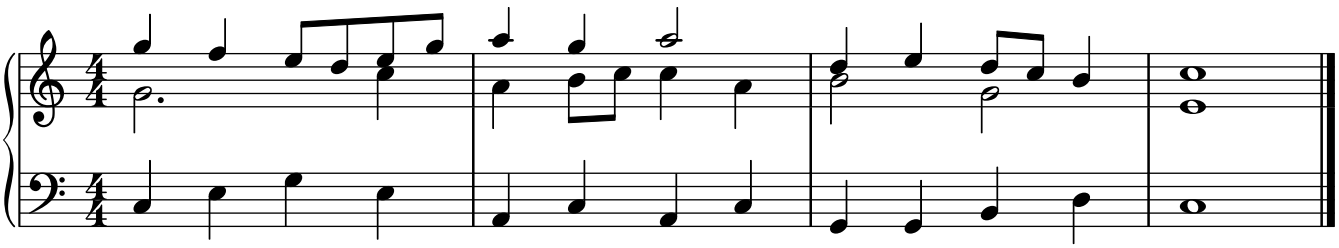
☐ **1.3**



☐ **1.4**



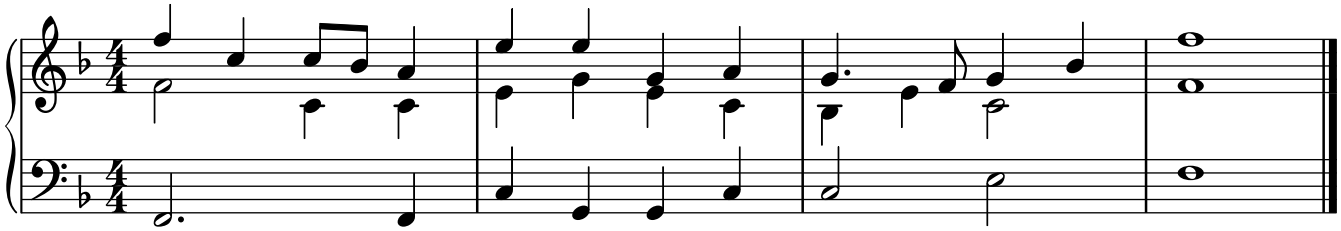
☐ **1.5**



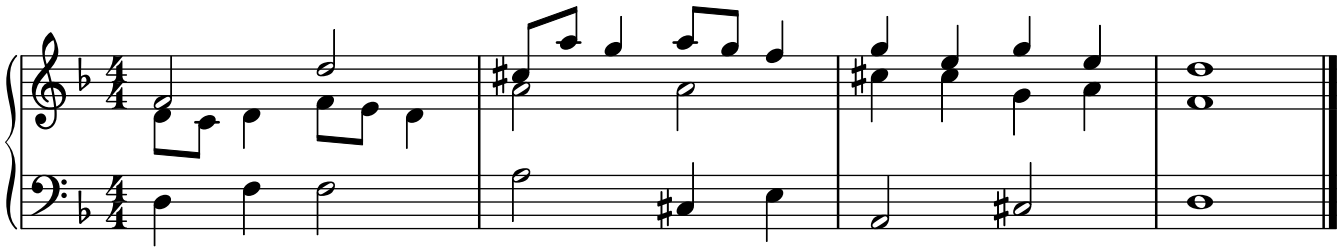
☐ **1.6**



☐ **1.7**



☐ **1.8**



Part B: The middle voice changes hands ♩ = 60

The middle voice changes hands: in some bars it is on the upper staff (right hand), in others on the lower staff (left hand). Eight bars.

☐ **1.9**



☐ **1.10**



☐ **1.11**



☐ **1.12**



☐ **1.13**



☐ **1.14**



☐ **1.15**



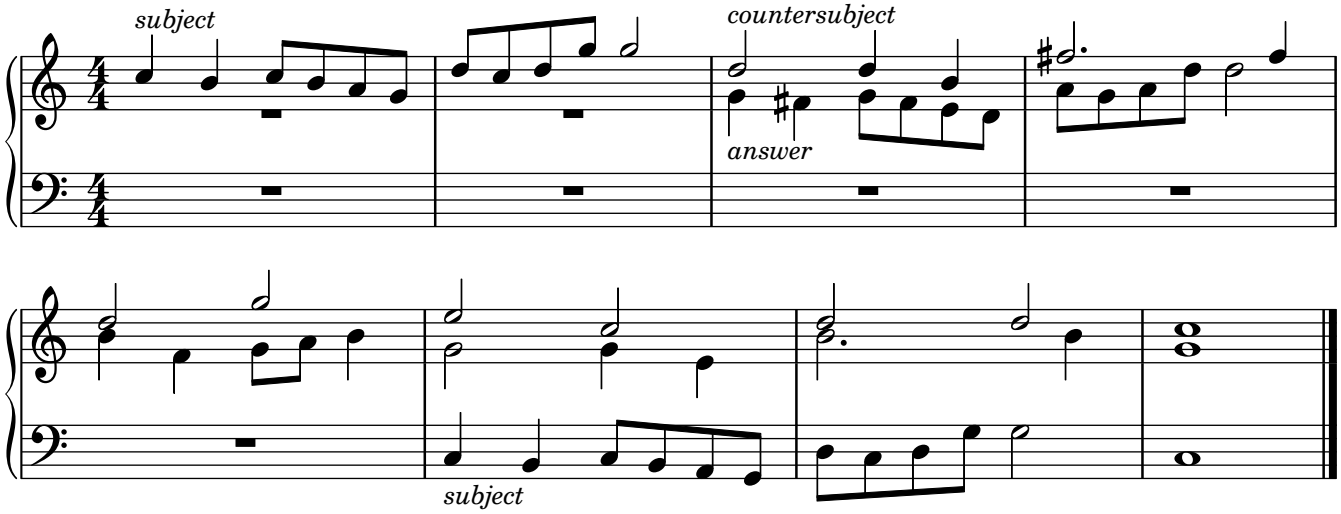
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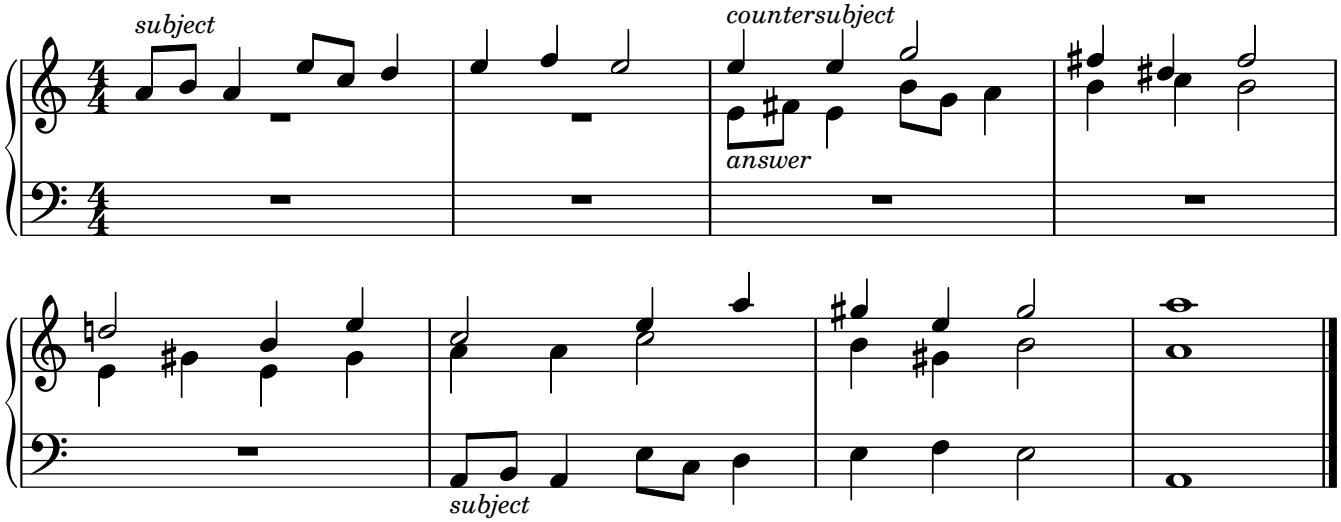
Part C: Subject, answer, countersubject ♩ = 56

Fugue entries: the subject in the top voice (bars 1-2), the answer in the middle voice (bars 3-4) with the countersubject above it, a one-bar link, then the subject in the bass (bars 6-7) and the closing chord. The first four exercises label each entry; find them yourself in the others.

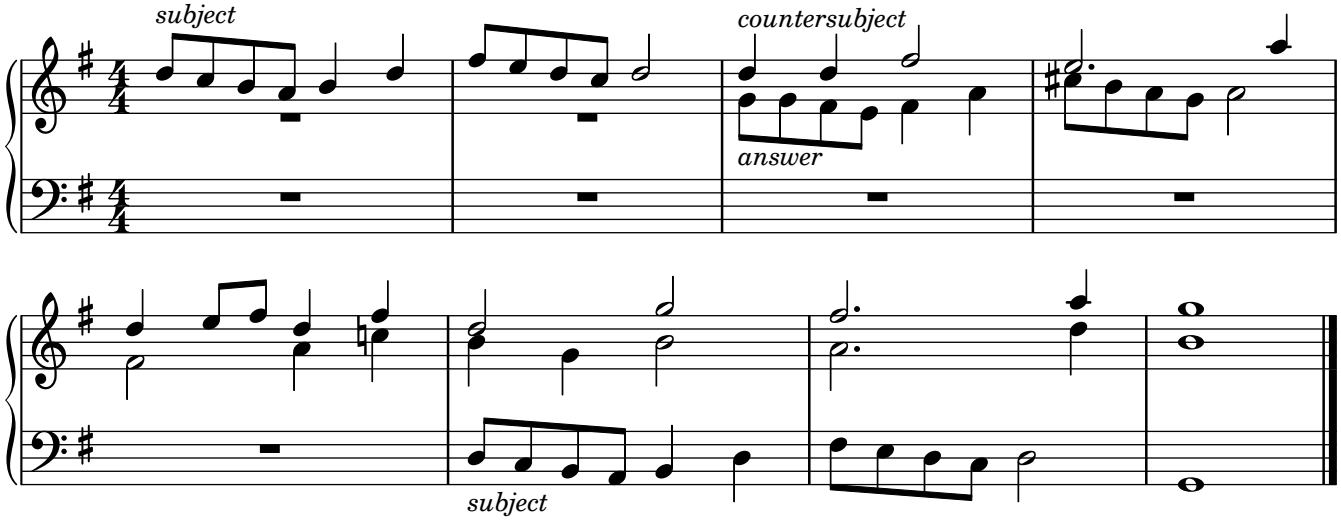
☐ **1.17**



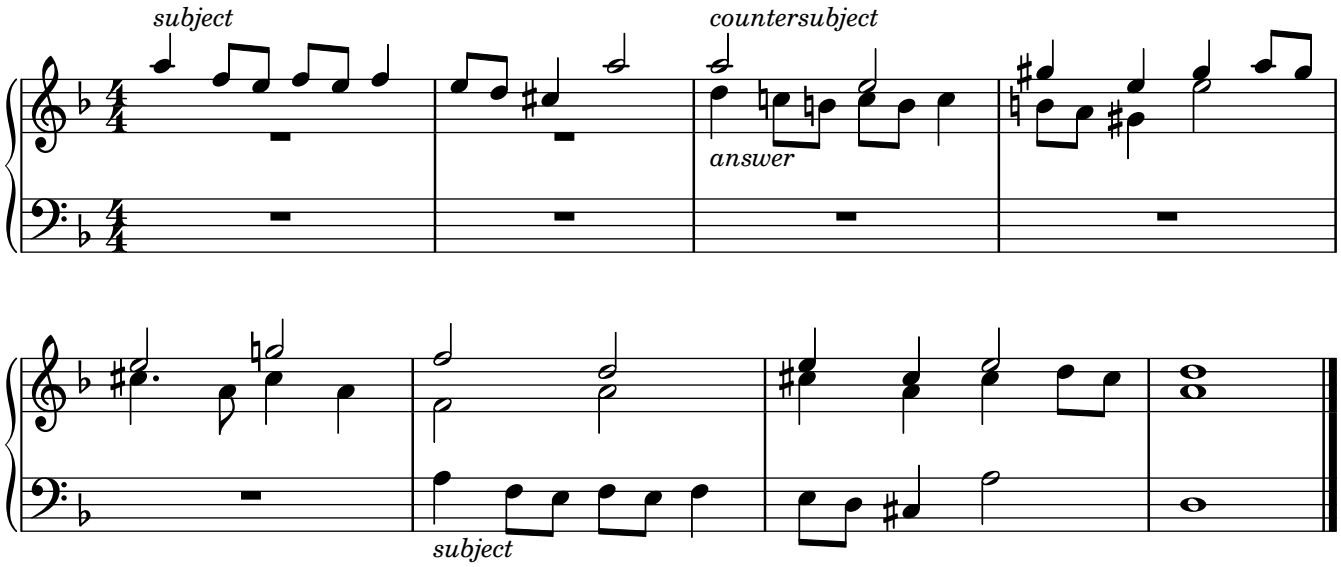
☐ **1.18**



☐ **1.19**



☐ **1.20**



☐ **1.21**



☐ **1.22**



☐ **1.23**



☐ **1.24**



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Sinfonia No. 1 ♩= 60

J. S. Bach, Sinfonia No. 1 in C, BWV 787 - bars 1-6, with a closing chord

The top voice opens with a rising scale; in bar 2 the middle voice imitates it, starting in the left hand (stems up on the lower staff) and moving up into the right hand. In bar 6 the middle voice runs down into the left hand again and stays there. The bass imitates the scale in bars 3-5. The excerpt ends with a C major chord in place of Bach's bar 7. Source: Mutopia Project no. 142 (public domain).



Sinfonia No. 11 ♩. = 50

J. S. Bach, Sinfonia No. 11 in G minor, BWV 797 - bars 1-16

Three voices in 3/8, one beat in a bar. The top voice starts with a broken G minor chord; one bar later the middle voice copies it a fourth lower, and in bar 8 the bass, two octaves lower. Each time the broken chord runs down, its lowest note may be printed on the lower staff: the left hand takes it. In bar 12 that note is the C the left hand is already holding. Bar 9 has a short trill on B (the zig-zag sign: alternate B and C quickly), finished by two thirty-second notes. The excerpt ends in B-flat major, where Bach's first phrase closes. Source: Mutopia Project no. 200 (public domain).



Fugue in C minor ♩= 60

J. S. Bach, The Well-Tempered Clavier I, Fugue in C minor, BWV 847 - bars 1-8, with a closing chord

The exposition of a famous fugue. The alto plays the subject alone (bars 1-2); the soprano answers it a fifth higher (bars 3-4), a tonal answer: the subject's leap down to G becomes a leap down to C, while the alto plays the countersubject in the left hand, in the treble clef. Bars 5-6 are an episode built from the subject's first notes. In bar 7 the bass enters with the subject and the alto comes back to the right hand. The closing chord (with the bass falling from E-flat to C) is added here; Bach's fugue goes on. Source: Mutopia Project no. 1941 (Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0, typeset by Urs Metzger).



Fugue in G ♩= 60

Original, written for this book

A small fugue made with the rules of Part C. The soprano plays the subject (bars 1-2); the alto answers it a fourth lower with a tonal answer: the subject's first note, D, is answered by G (see the example in this unit), while the soprano plays the countersubject. Bar 5 is a short episode in D major. In bar 6 the bass plays the subject two octaves lower, and bars 8-9 close in G.



Checkpoint

- Play two exercises from Part C a day for a week: name each entry (subject, answer, subject in the bass) before you play, then play without stopping.
- Pass if you can play the Fugue in G and Part B's exercises at sight, steadily, with every held note held, and Sinfonia No. 1 after a few days.

Unit 2

Rhythm Against Rhythm

New: Two against three, three against four, duplets, quintuplets and septuplets, hemiola

Until now both hands have shared one way of dividing the beat: both in eighths, or both in triplets. In much Romantic and Impressionist music the hands divide the beat differently: the right hand plays three notes while the left plays two, or the tune floats in free groups of five or seven over a steady accompaniment. This unit teaches you to feel two rhythms at once.

The secret is to keep one hand completely steady (usually the accompaniment) and let the other fit around it. Practise the combinations slowly with the rhymes below until they are automatic; then read the exercises at the speed shown.

What is new

Two against three

Three triplet eighths in one hand, two eighths in the other: both hands play together on the beat; the second eighth comes exactly between the 2nd and 3rd triplet notes. Say "nice cup of tea": "nice" together, "cup" triplet, "of" eighth, "tea" triplet.

Three against four

Triplet eighths in one hand, sixteenths in the other: together on the beat, then the notes interlock. Say "pass the golden butter": "pass" together, then sixteenth, triplet, sixteenth, triplet, sixteenth.

Duplets

In 6/8 the beat is a dotted quarter, normally three eighths. A duplet (marked 2) fits two equal notes into the beat: each one lasts one and a half eighths. The left hand's three eighths go on underneath: it is two against three again.

Runs of 5, 6 and 7

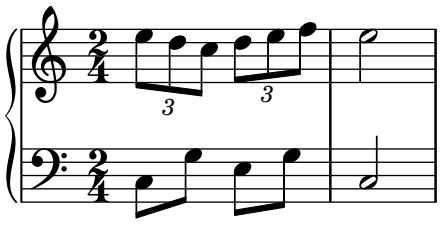
A group of 5, 6 or 7 small notes marked with its number fills one beat. Do not count them: start the run on the beat, aim for the note after it, and arrive on time. The left hand keeps the beat.

Hemiola

In 3/4, two bars can suddenly move in half notes: three half notes across the two bars, the middle one tied over the bar line. The music sounds as if it were in 3/2 for a moment. Accents show it; keep counting 1-2-3 and feel the slower beat on top.

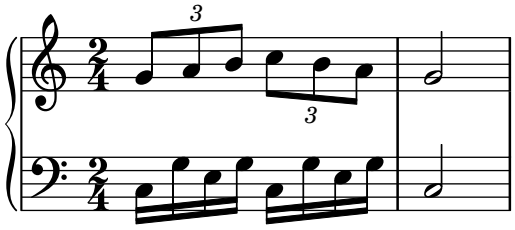
Two against three

Right hand triplets, left hand eighths. Both hands play on each beat; the left hand's second eighth falls exactly between the second and third notes of the triplet.



Three against four

Triplet eighths against sixteenths: together on the beat, then sixteenth, triplet, sixteenth, triplet, sixteenth ("pass the golden butter").



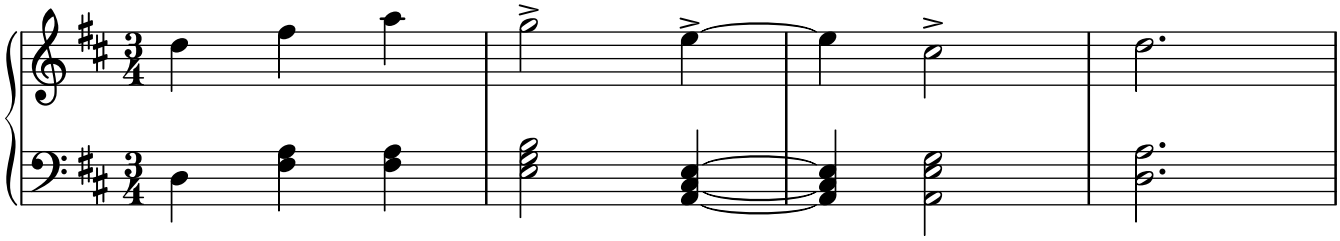
A duplet in 6/8, and a run of five

Bar 1: the duplet (two notes in the time of three eighths) against the left hand's eighths. Bar 2: five notes fill the first beat and lead into the half note.



A hemiola

Bars 2-3 move in three half notes, the middle one tied over the bar line. Keep counting three beats in a bar, and let the accents carry the slower pulse.



Reading tips

1. Practise each new combination with one hand tapping and the other clapping before you read it.
2. Keep the accompaniment perfectly even; fit the other hand around it.
3. Look at where the two hands play together: those points are your anchors.
4. In a run, look at the note after the run first: that is where you must arrive, on the beat.
5. In a hemiola, do not change your counting: feel the half notes against it.

Part A: Two against three ♩= 60

Two against three. In half of the exercises the right hand has the tune in eighths over the left hand's triplets; in the other half the left hand has the tune and the right hand plays the triplets.

☐ **2.1**



☐ **2.2**



☐ **2.3**



2.4



2.5



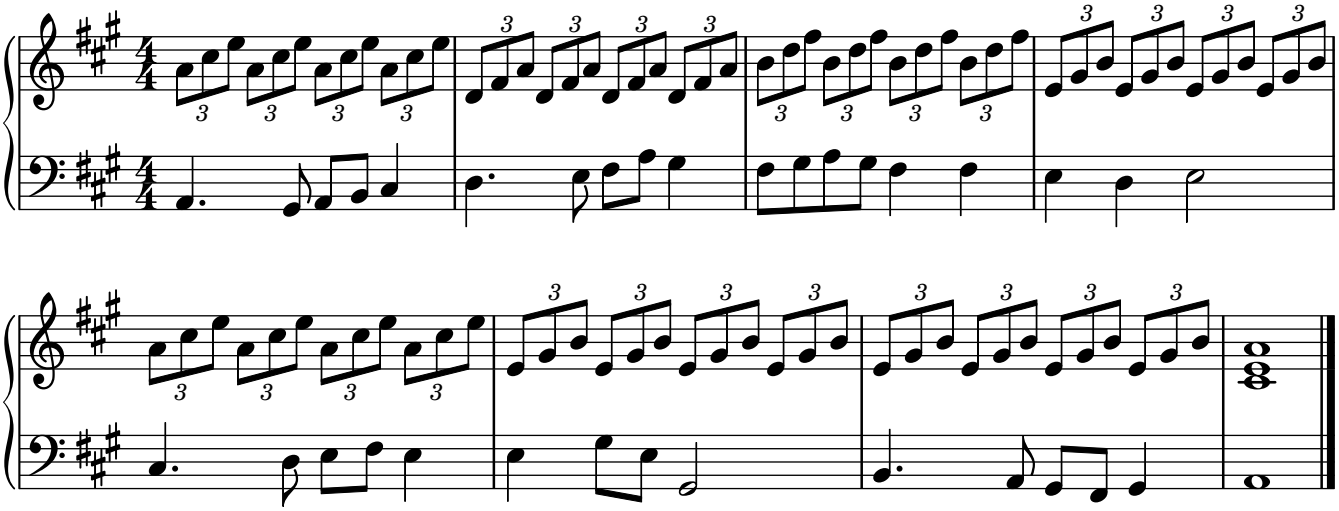
2.6



☐ **2.7**



☐ **2.8**



Part B: Duplets, and three against four ♩. = 56

Duplets in 6/8 (two notes in a dotted-quarter beat) over the left hand's eighths, alternating with 2/4 exercises in which right-hand triplets meet left-hand sixteenths (three against four).

☐ **2.9**



☐ **2.10** ♩ = 56



☐ **2.11**



2.12 ♩ = 56



2.13



2.14 ♩ = 56



2.15



2.16 ♩ = 56



Part C: Runs of 5, 6 and 7 notes, and hemiolas ♩= 60

Runs of 5, 6 or 7 notes (two in each exercise), alternating with 3/4 waltzes that end with a hemiola in bars 6-7.

☐ **2.17**



☐ **2.18** ♩= 96



☐ **2.19**



2.20 ♩ = 96



2.21



2.22 ♩ = 96



2.23



2.24 ♩ = 96



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Arabesque No. 1 ♩ = 63

Claude Debussy (1888-91), Arabesque No. 1, L. 66 - bars 6-12, with a closing chord

Two against three all through: the right hand's triplets float over the left hand's even eighths. Keep the left hand quiet and perfectly steady; in bars 5-7 the right hand mixes triplets with plain eighths. Four sharps: E major. Debussy's piece goes on; the excerpt closes on an E major chord. Source: Mutopia Project no. 1777 (public domain).



Nocturne in E-flat ♩. = 44

Frederic Chopin (1830-32), Nocturne Op. 9 No. 2 - the first phrase

12/8: four beats of three eighths. The left hand keeps an even bass-and-chord pattern of eighths while the tune sings freely above it. In bar 2 the four quick notes are Chopin's turn written out (D-flat, C, B-natural, C, all in the time of one eighth); in bar 4 the sixteenths make two notes against each eighth of the left hand. Count four slow beats, not twelve. The excerpt ends with the first phrase. Notes retyped from the Mutopia Project engraving no. 1590 (Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 3.0).



Solace ♩= 60

Scott Joplin (1909), Solace: A Mexican Serenade - the first strain

A habanera: the left hand plays a dotted eighth, a sixteenth and two eighths in every bar, while the right hand's sixteenths are tied over the middle of the bar. The two rhythms never coincide after the first note: keep the left hand's pattern steady and fit the right hand's ties against it. Joplin marks it "very slow march time". Joplin writes each bass note held under the chord (for the pedal); here it is printed as the eighth the hand actually plays. Source: Mutopia Project no. 482 (public domain).



Hemiola Waltz ♩ = 104

Original, written for this book

A waltz with two hemiolas. In bars 7-8 and 13-14 the music moves in three half notes across two bars (the accents show them; the middle one is tied over the bar line): the first time it stops on A, the dominant, the second time it leads home to D. Keep counting three in a bar and let the half notes sound broad and slow.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 3?

- Play two new exercises from each part at the speeds shown, with no more than one stop each.
- Pass if the hands keep their own rhythms: the triplets stay even against the eighths, the duplets are equal, and every run arrives on the beat.
- Pass if you can play the Hemiola Waltz at sight and the Arabesque excerpt after a few days.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 3.

Unit 3

Changing Meters, Modes and No Key

New: Changing meters (5/4, 7/8, 5/8); modes; pentatonic and whole-tone scales; no bar lines

So far every piece has kept one time signature from start to finish, and its key signature has told you the key. Many composers since 1870 do neither: the time signature changes every bar or two, bars of 5 or 7 beats appear, the music uses an old mode or a scale with no key at all, and sometimes there are no bar lines. Reading this music means trusting the page bar by bar: look at each new time signature as it comes, count the beat groups that the beams show, and read every accidental as written.

What is new

Changing time signatures

A new time signature is printed only when the meter changes; it lasts until the next one. Keep the quarter (or eighth) the same speed: only the number of beats in the bar changes. 5/4 is usually 3 + 2 beats, 6/4 is 3 + 3.

7/8 and 5/8

In 7/8 the eighth is the unit and the bar has three uneven beats, shown by the beams: 2 + 2 + 3 (count "one-two, one-two, one-two-three"). 5/8 is 3 + 2 or 2 + 3. The long beat is the one with three eighths.

Modes

A mode uses the notes of a major scale but makes a different note the home note. Dorian (D to D on the white keys) is a minor scale with a raised 6th; Mixolydian (G to G) a major scale with a lowered 7th; Phrygian (E to E) a minor scale with a lowered 2nd; Lydian (F to F) a major scale with a raised 4th. Modal music is often printed without a key signature: find the home note from the bass and the last note.

Whole-tone and pentatonic scales

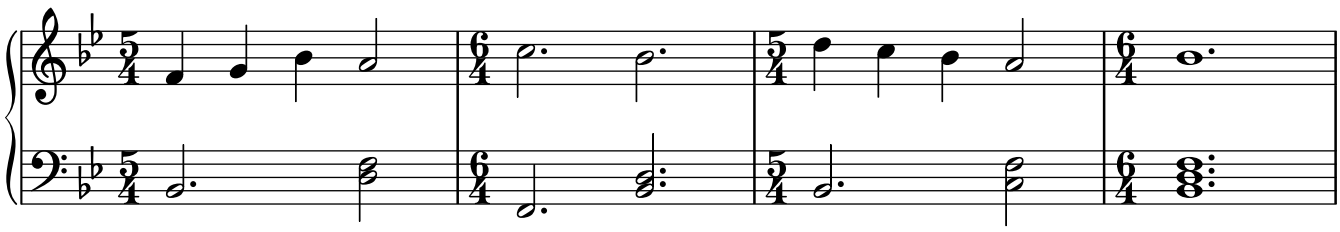
The pentatonic scale has five notes (C D E G A: no half steps); the whole-tone scale has six notes a whole step apart (C D E F-sharp G-sharp A-sharp). Both float without a strong pull home.

Music without bar lines

With no time signature and no bar lines, read in phrases: dotted bar lines (or none) mark where a phrase ends. Keep a steady quarter beat; an accidental lasts until the next bar line, so in unbarred music it may last a long time.

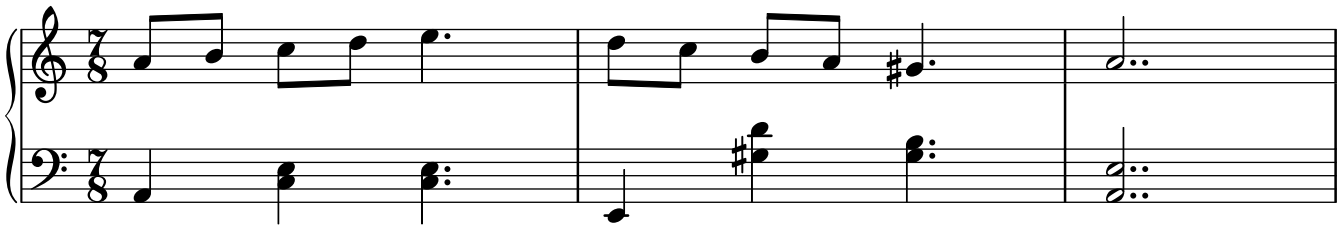
5/4 and 6/4

The quarter note stays the same speed; the bars alternate between five beats (3 + 2) and six (3 + 3).



7/8 as 2 + 2 + 3

The beams show the beat groups: two short beats and a long one. Count "one-two, one-two, one-two-three".



D Dorian, without a key signature

The white keys from D to D. It sounds minor (F is a minor third above D), but B, the 6th, is raised. The bass and the final note tell you the home note is D.



Pentatonic and whole-tone scales

The pentatonic scale on C (five notes, no half steps), then the whole-tone scale on C (six notes, all a whole step apart), written without bar lines.



Reading tips

1. Before you play, find every time signature in the exercise and say the beat groups aloud.
2. Keep the short note value (quarter or eighth) at one speed through every change of meter.
3. With no key signature, look at the bass and the last note to find the home note, then name the mode.
4. In unbarred music, read in phrases and breathe at the dotted bar lines.
5. An accidental lasts until the next bar line: in unbarred music, look back for the last one.

Part A: Changing meters ♩= 88

Changing meters: bars of 5/4 and 6/4 alternating (as in Mussorgsky's Promenade), alternating with exercises in which 3/4 and 2/4 bars mix. The left hand plays the beat groups: a bass note for the first group, the chord for the others.

☐ **3.1**



☐ **3.2**



☐ **3.3**



☐ **3.4**



☐ **3.5**



☐ **3.6**



☐ **3.7**



3.8



Part B: 7/8, 5/8 and the modes ♪ = 160

7/8 (2 + 2 + 3) and 5/8 (3 + 2), alternating with tunes in the modes printed without a key signature: A Dorian, D Mixolydian, E Phrygian and F Lydian. Name the mode's home note before you play.

☐ **3.9**



☐ **3.10** ♩ = 72



☐ **3.11**



3.12 ♩ = 72



3.13



3.14 ♩ = 72



3.15



3.16 ♩ = 72



Part C: No bar lines: pentatonic and whole-tone ♩ = 72

Without bar lines: pentatonic tunes over an open fifth, and whole-tone tunes over a major third. Dotted bar lines end the phrases.

☐ **3.17**



☐ **3.18**



☐ **3.19**



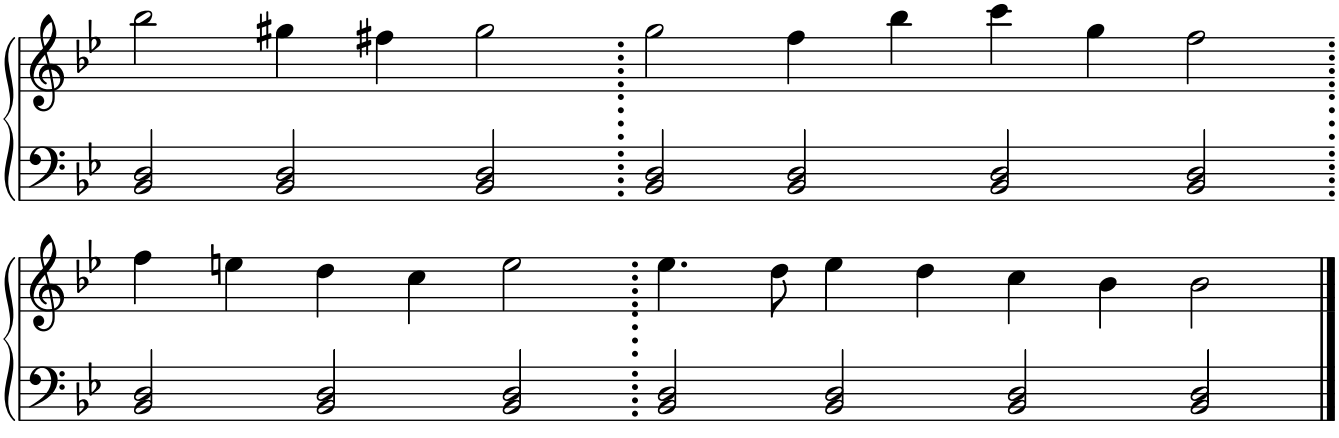
3.20



3.21



3.22



3.23



3.24



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Promenade ♩ = 92

Modest Mussorgsky (1874), Pictures at an Exhibition: Promenade - bars 1-6, with a closing chord

The time signature changes every bar: 5/4, 6/4, 5/4 ... Keep the quarter note steady. The tune starts alone, like a soloist, and the whole group answers in chords (bars 3-4); then the solo and the answer come again. Mussorgsky's direction: "in the Russian manner, not fast". The left hand plays in octaves. In bars 3-4 a low C under the right hand's first quarter is left out (it is out of reach of one hand). Source: Mutopia Project no. 475 (public domain).



Dance in Seven ♪ = 176

Original, written for this book

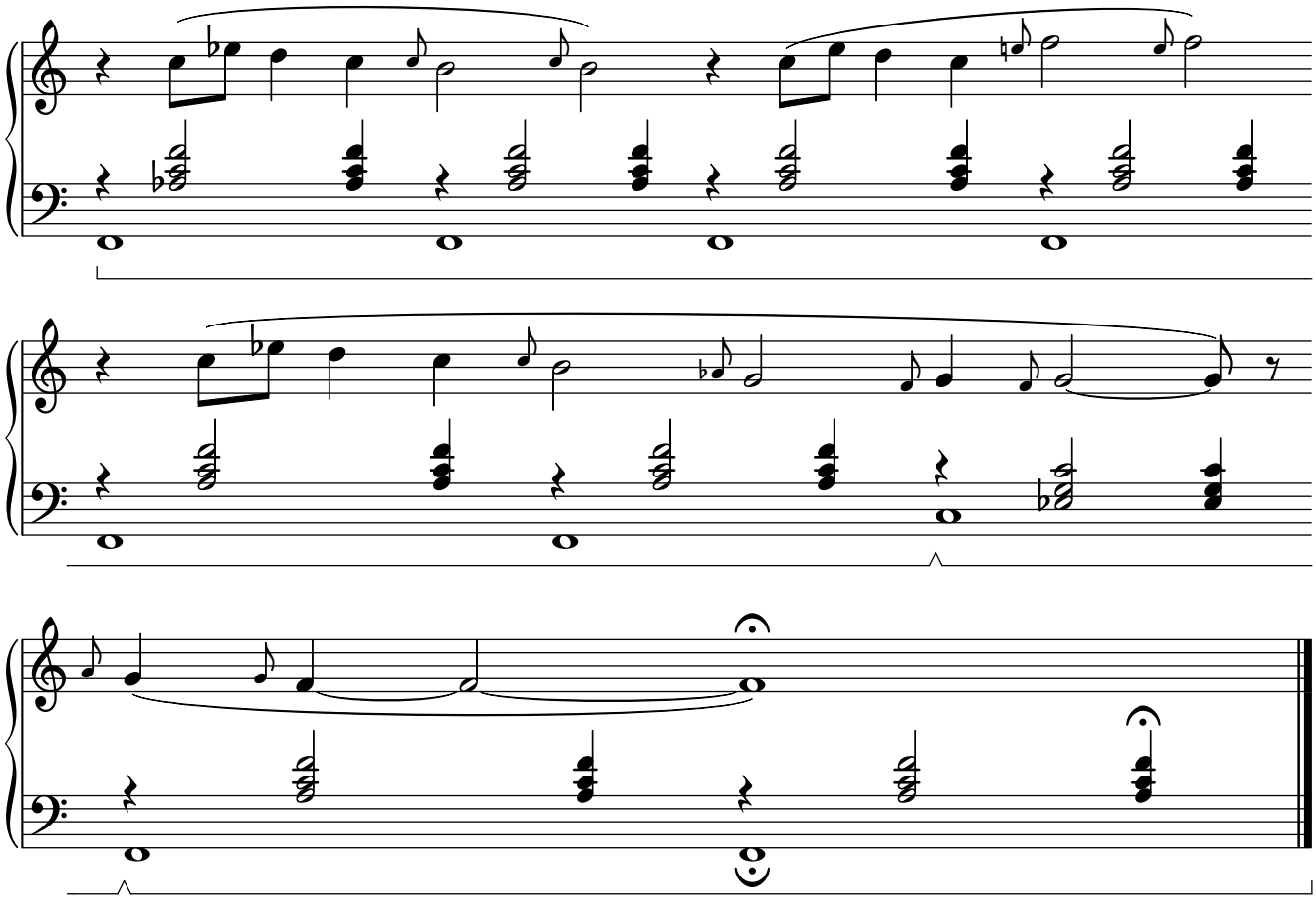
A dance in 7/8, grouped 2 + 2 + 3 in every bar: the beams show the groups, and the left hand plays a bass note on the first group and chords on the other two. The long third beat gives the dance its limp. Count "one-two, one-two, one-two-three" before you start.



Gnossienne No. 1 ♩= 60

Erik Satie (1890), Gnossienne No. 1 - the first theme

No time signature and no bar lines: read in phrases, keeping a slow, even quarter beat. Every phrase starts after a rest and the tune is full of grace notes (play them quickly, just before the beat). The left hand plays a low F and then a chord, again and again, with the pedal (it changes when the bass changes); count four slow beats for each bass note. An accidental lasts until the end of the line here: watch the B (natural) and the E (natural and flat). Notes retyped from the Mutopia Project engraving no. 2035 (Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0).



Scarborough Fair ♩= 100

Traditional English ballad, arranged for this book

A tune in D Dorian, printed without a key signature. It looks like C major, but D is the home note: the bass starts and ends on it. The Dorian sound comes from B natural, the raised 6th, in bar 7 (the tune) and in the G major chords. Sing the tune in your head as you play: it is a song.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 4?

- Play two new exercises from each part at the speeds shown, with no more than one stop each.
- Pass if every change of meter is counted correctly (the quarter or eighth keeps its speed) and you name the mode of each Part B exercise before you play.
- Pass if you can play the Dance in Seven and Scarborough Fair at sight, and the Promenade after a few days.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 4.

Unit 4

Chromatic Harmony

New: Secondary dominants, diminished sevenths, Neapolitan and augmented sixths, modulation

Romantic music is full of notes outside the key: sharps and flats that appear for one chord and vanish. Read one by one, they are a forest of accidentals. Read as chords, they are a handful of familiar shapes: the dominant seventh of a chord other than the tonic, the diminished seventh, the Neapolitan sixth and the augmented sixths. Each one has a strong pull towards the chord that follows. This unit's exercises are written as four-part harmony at the keyboard: the right hand plays three voices, the left hand the bass. Name each chord as you meet it and let your hands find the shape; then listen for where each chromatic note goes.

What is new

Secondary dominants

Any major or minor chord of the key can have its own dominant seventh: V7 of V (in C: D F-sharp A C) leads to G, V7 of ii (A C-sharp E G) leads to D minor. The sharp is the leading note of the chord that follows: it rises a half step; the 7th falls.

Diminished sevenths

Four notes a minor third apart (B D F A-flat in C). The bottom note is a leading note and rises; the top note falls. Every chord of the key can have one: vii°7 of V is F-sharp A C E-flat.

The Neapolitan sixth

In a minor key, the major chord on the lowered 2nd (in A minor: B-flat D F), usually with its third (D) in the bass. It goes to V: the B-flat falls to G-sharp.

The augmented sixths

Built on the lowered 6th in the bass (in A minor: F) with the raised 4th above it (D-sharp): an augmented sixth that opens out to the octave E-E. The Italian sixth adds the tonic (F A D-sharp), the French sixth also the 2nd (F A B D-sharp), the German sixth the 3rd (F A C D-sharp, which goes to the tonic 6/4 chord first).

Double sharps and flats

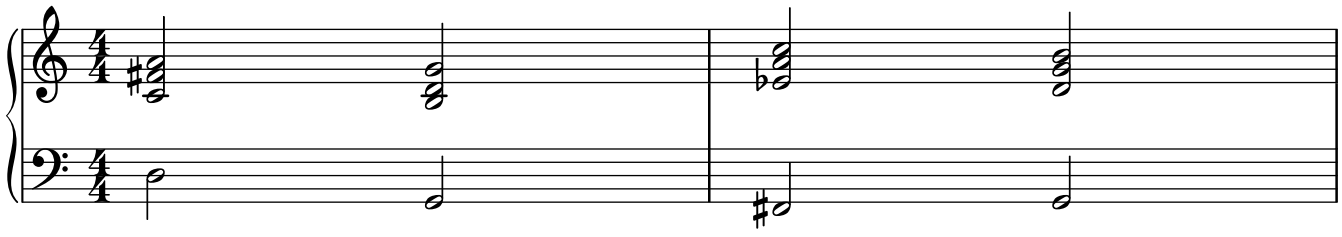
In sharp keys a raised note may already be sharp: in E major, V7 of vi is G-sharp B-sharp D-sharp F-sharp, and its diminished seventh B-sharp D-sharp F-sharp A. A double sharp raises a natural note by two half steps.

Modulation

A pivot chord belongs to both keys (in C major, A minor is vi; in G major it is ii) and leads to the new key's V7. A diminished seventh can be respelled: B D F A-flat in C is the same sound as G-sharp B D F, the diminished seventh of A, so it can lead to a key a minor third away.

V7 of V and the diminished seventh of V

In C major: D7 (F-sharp rises to G, C falls to B), then F-sharp A C E-flat (F-sharp rises, E-flat falls).



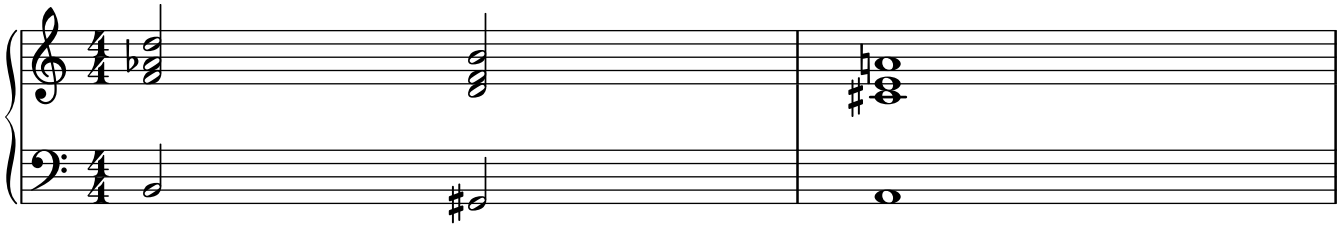
The Neapolitan sixth and the augmented sixths in A minor

N6 (B-flat falls to G-sharp), the Italian sixth, the French sixth, and the German sixth through the tonic 6/4: in each, F in the bass falls to E and D-sharp rises to E.



One sound, two spellings

The diminished seventh of C (B D F A-flat) is respelled as the diminished seventh of A (G-sharp B D F) and resolves to A major.



Reading tips

1. Name each chromatic chord before you play it: "V7 of V", "diminished seventh", "Neapolitan".

2. A sharp (or natural that raises a note) is usually a leading note: expect it to rise. A flat usually falls.

3. Hold the common notes between chords and move the others the shortest way.

4. In the first two exercises of each part the chords are named under the bass: read the names, then the notes.

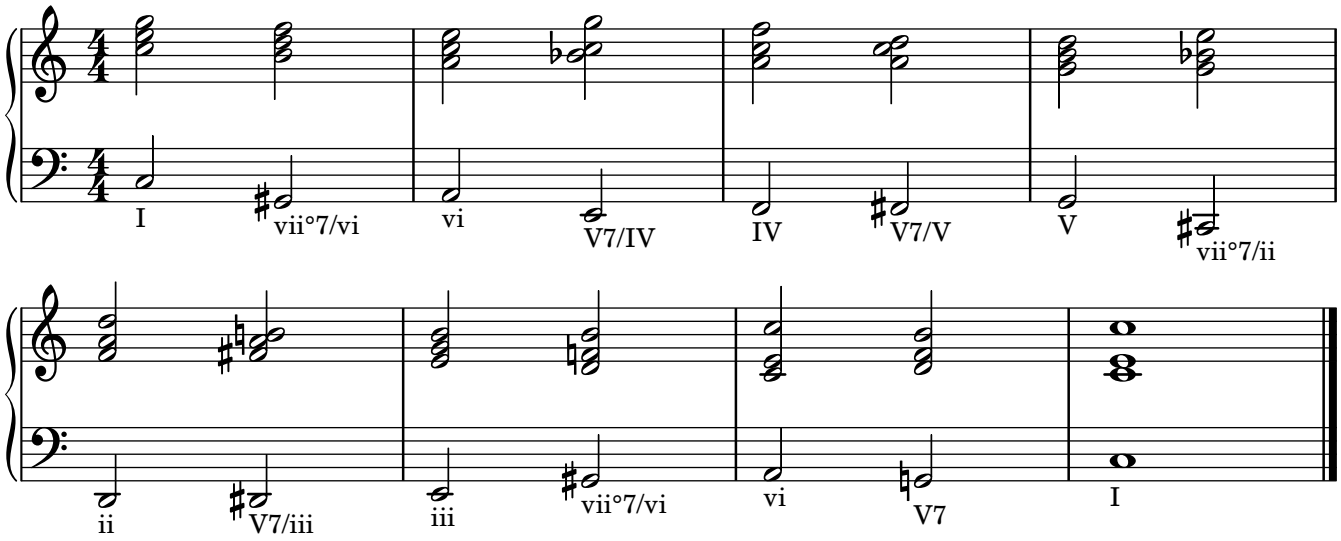
5. After a modulation, check the new key signature before you read on.

Part A: Secondary dominants and diminished 7ths

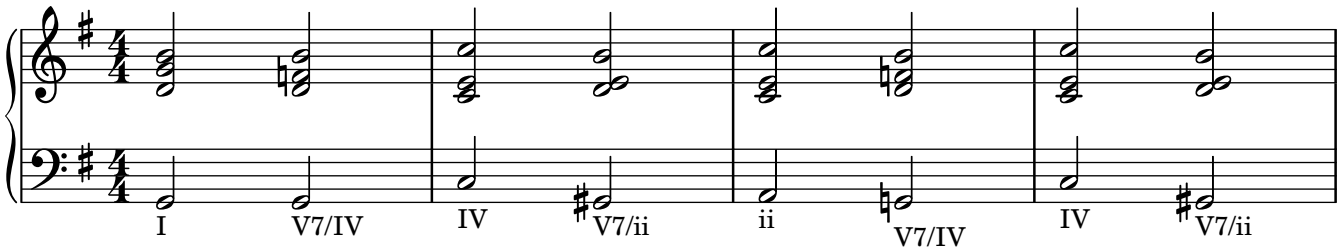
♩ = 56

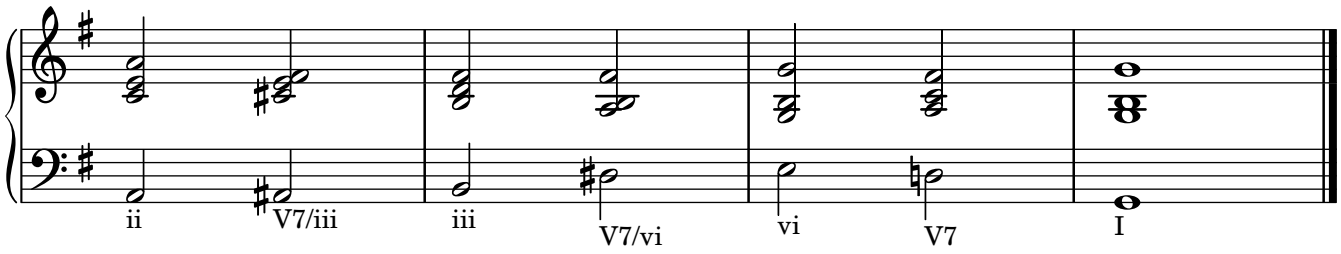
Secondary dominants (V7 of ii, iii, IV, V or vi) and diminished sevenths (vii°7 of the same chords), each followed by its chord; the cadence V7-I at the end. Right hand: three upper voices; left hand: the bass. The first two exercises name the chords.

☐ **4.1**



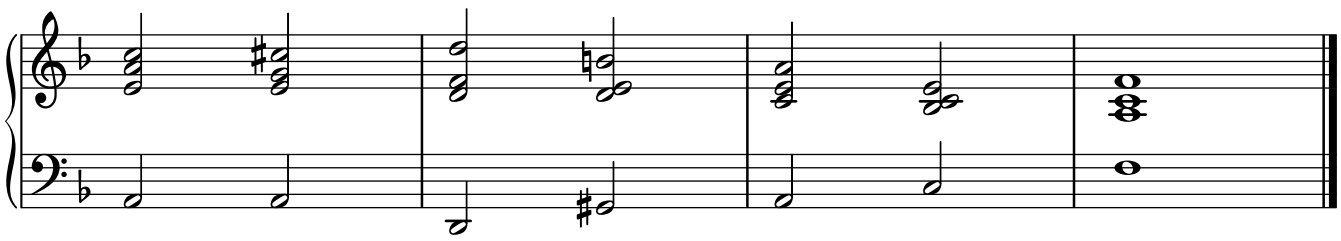
☐ **4.2**



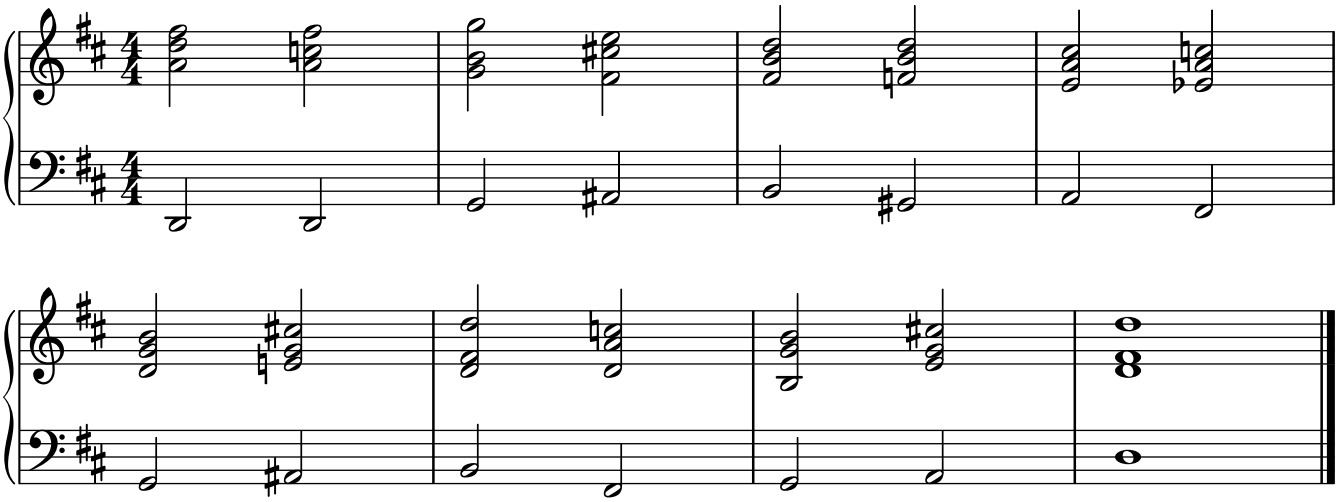


☐ **4.3**





☐ **4.4**



☐ **4.5**



☐ **4.6**



☐ **4.7**



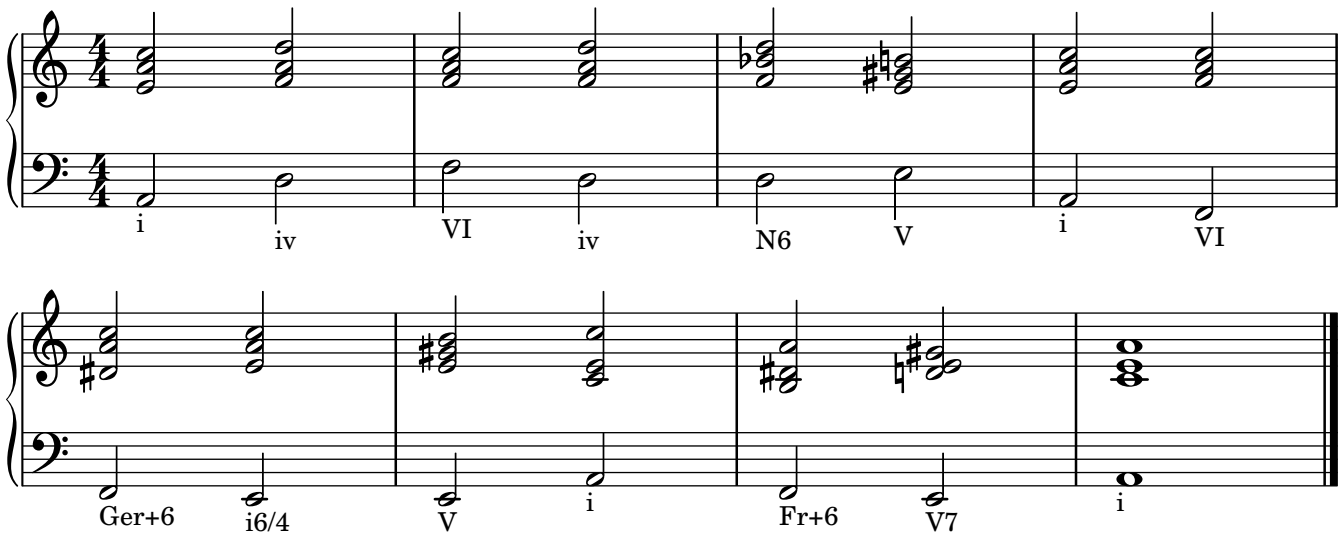
☐ **4.8**



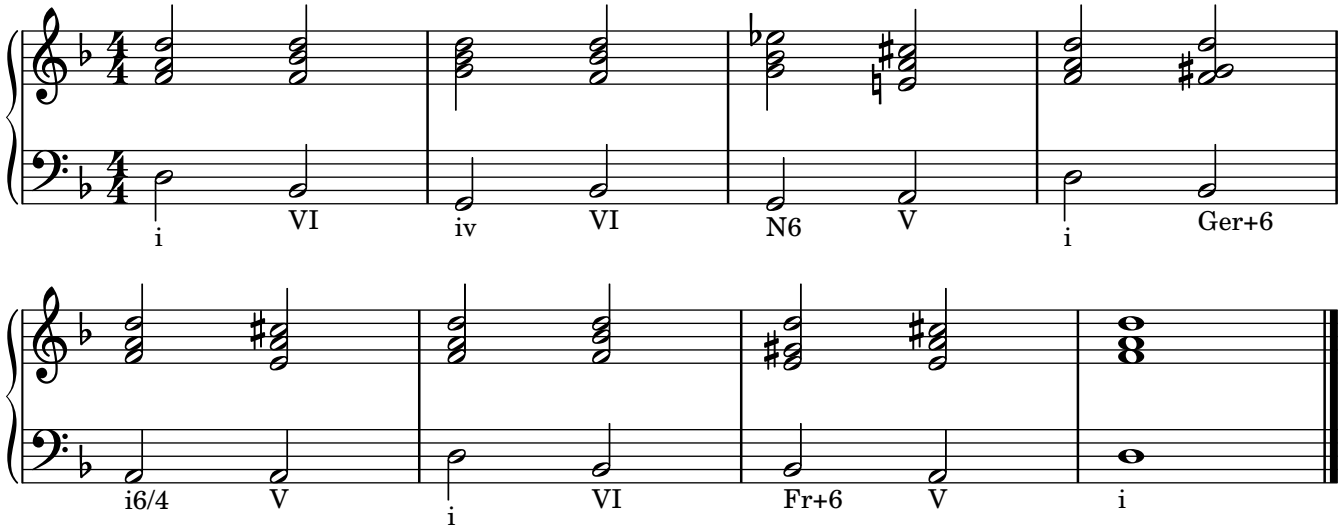
Part B: Neapolitan and augmented sixths ♩ = 56

Minor keys: three cadences in each exercise, each prepared by a Neapolitan sixth or an augmented sixth (Italian, French, or German through the 6/4 chord). The first two exercises name the chords.

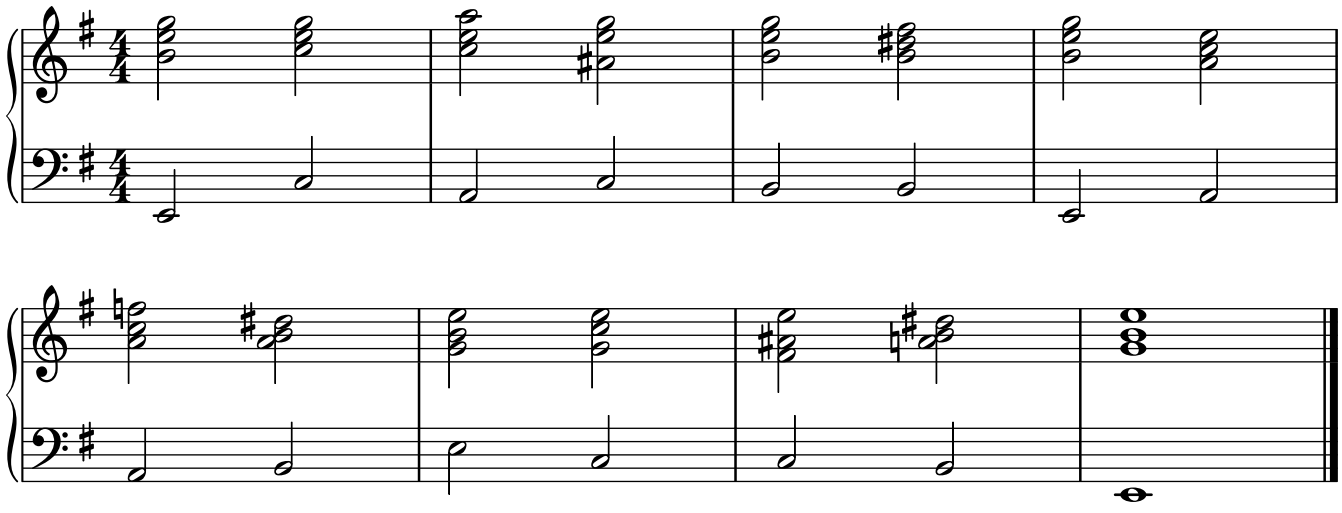
☐ **4.9**



☐ **4.10**



☐ **4.11**



☐ **4.12**



☐ **4.13**



☐ **4.14**



4.15



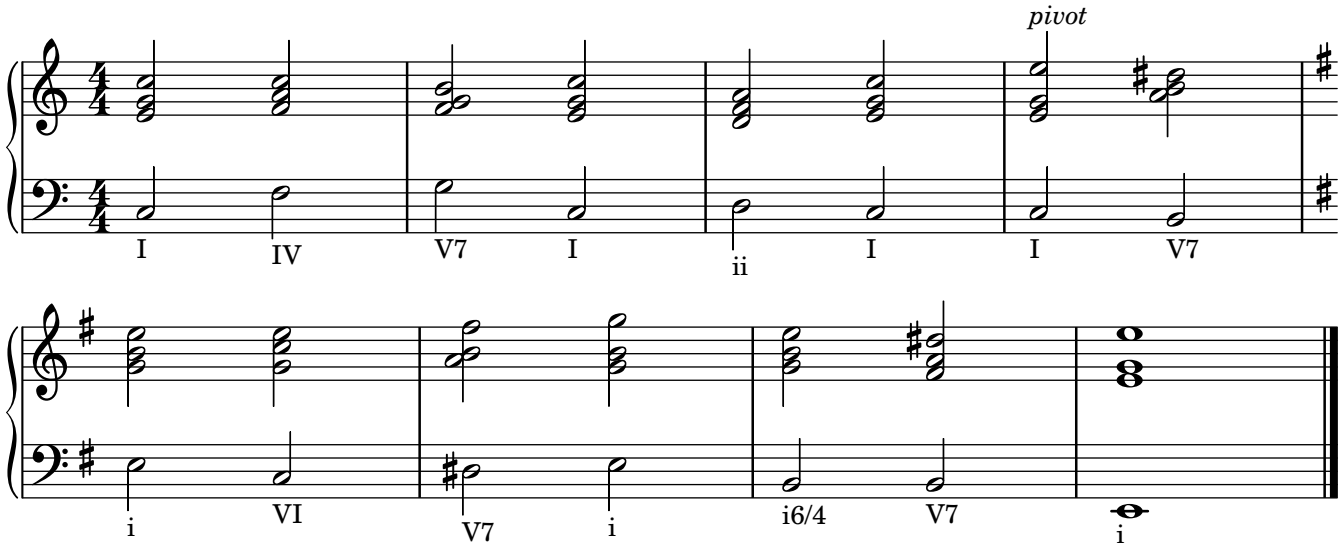
4.16



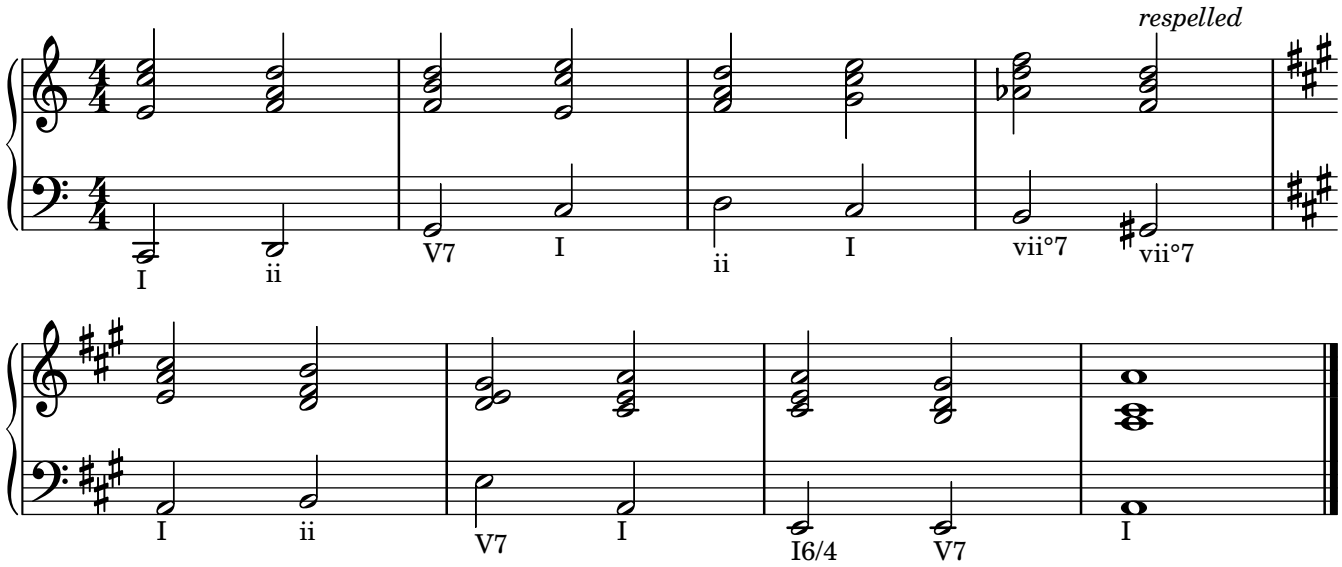
Part C: Pivot chords and diminished sevenths ♩ = 56

Modulation: three bars in the first key, a pivot bar, and four bars in the new key, whose key signature appears in bar 5. Odd-numbered exercises use a pivot chord (marked "pivot" in the first one); the even-numbered use a diminished seventh, respelled (marked in the second).

☐ **4.17**



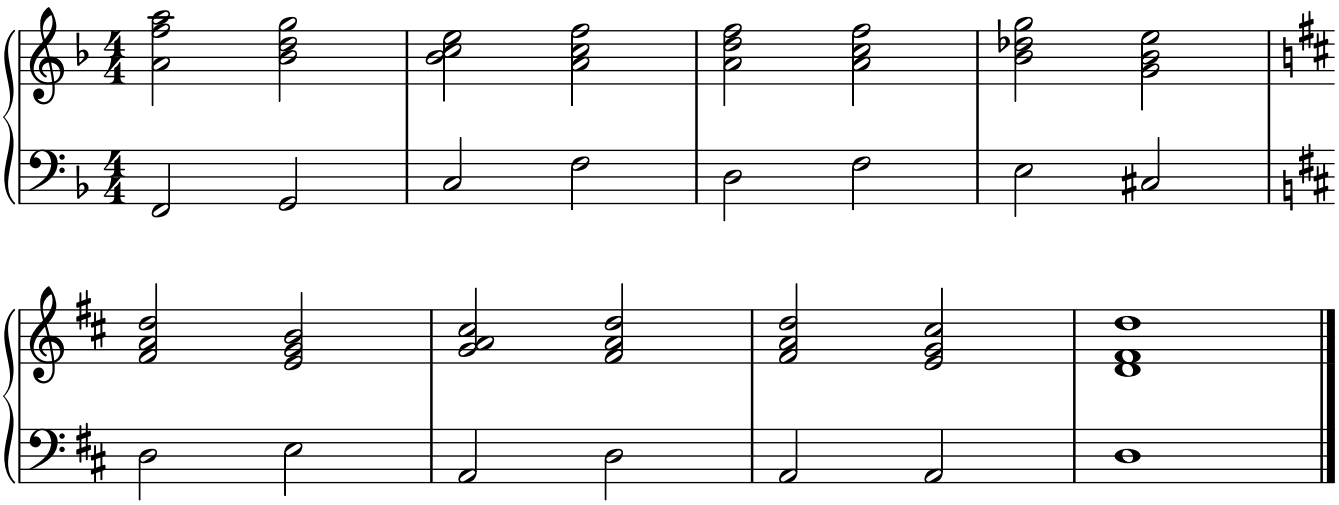
☐ **4.18**



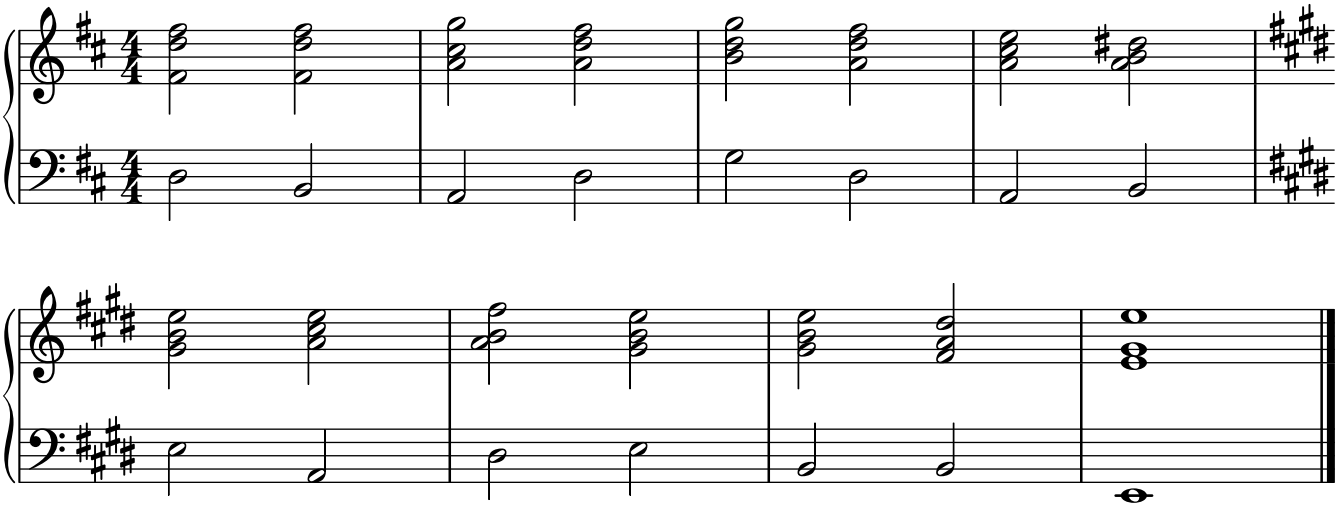
☐ **4.19**



☐ **4.20**



☐ **4.21**



☐ **4.22**



4.23



4.24



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Prelude in C minor ♩ = 42

Frederic Chopin (1839), Prelude Op. 28 No. 20 - bars 1-8, with the closing chord

A slow procession of chords, one on each beat. Bar 2 goes from A-flat to D-flat major: the Neapolitan chord (here with its root in the bass); bar 3 has C7, the dominant seventh of iv; bar 4 has D7 over C, the dominant seventh of V. From bar 5 the bass falls by half steps under the chords. The right hand starts in the bass clef. Use the pedal on every beat (marked in bar 1). On the third beat of bar 2 the right hand stretches a ninth (D-flat to E-flat): roll the chord quickly from the bottom if it is too wide. Source: Mutopia Project no. 472 (public domain).



Pathetique: Grave ♪ = 60

Ludwig van Beethoven (1798), Sonata Op. 13, first movement - bars 1-4, the run simplified

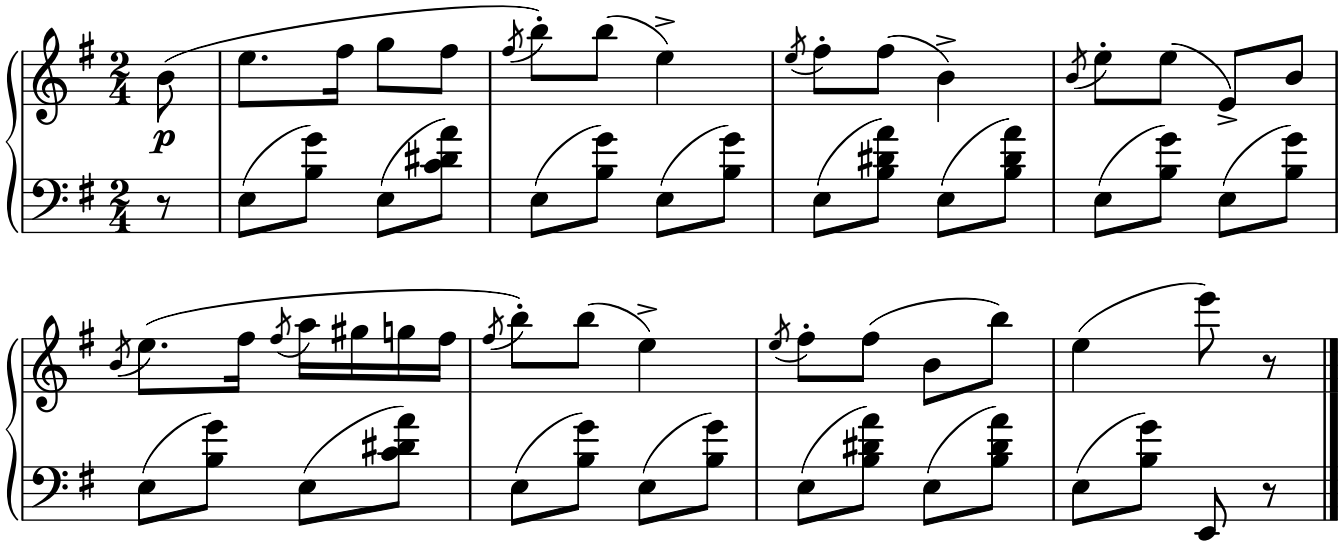
Count eighth notes: eight slow beats in a bar. Each phrase starts with a loud chord that suddenly becomes soft (fp) and rises through dotted rhythms to a chord full of tension: in bar 1 the diminished seventh A C E-flat (over F-sharp in the left hand) and in bar 3 the diminished seventh F-sharp A C E-flat. Bar 4 climbs to A-flat (sf) and runs down to E-flat; Beethoven's run is faster and longer (a written-out cadenza). The excerpt ends on the E-flat major chord of bar 5. Source: Mutopia Project no. 299 (public domain).



Album Leaf ♩ = 112

Edvard Grieg (1867), Lyric Pieces Op. 12 No. 7 - the first section

E minor over a pedal: the left hand plays E in the bass of every bar. In bars 1, 3, 5 and 7 the chord above it is chromatic: C, D-sharp and A (and B, D-sharp, A), a diminished seventh whose D-sharp leads to E. Bar 5 has a chromatic line in the tune: A, G-sharp, G, F-sharp. The small notes (acciaccaturas) are crushed in quickly before the beat. Notes retyped from the Mutopia Project engraving no. 2194 (Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0).



Modulation Study ♩ = 56

Original, written for this book

A journey from C major to E-flat major and back, in four-part harmony. Bar 3: the diminished seventh of C (B D F A-flat). Bar 4: the same sound, spelled as the diminished seventh of E-flat (C-flat D F A-flat; the bass B becomes C-flat), with E-flat's key signature; it goes to E-flat's tonic 6/4. Bar 6: the A-flat major chord is IV in E-flat and VI in C minor (a pivot), followed by the dominant seventh of C; bar 7 is in C major again.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 5?

- Play two new exercises from each part at the speed shown, with no more than one stop each.
- Pass if you can name the chromatic chords of Part A and Part B as you play them, and every leading note rises and every 7th falls.
- Pass if you can play the Modulation Study at sight and the Chopin Prelude after a few days.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 5.

Unit 5

Big Textures

New: Octaves, full chords, 8va and 8vb signs, three-staff piano music, crossed hands, simplifying

Late Romantic piano music fills the keyboard: tunes doubled in octaves, chords of five and six notes, arpeggios that sweep over three octaves, a left hand that crosses over the right, and sometimes a third staff when two are not enough. The notes are printed in signs that save ledger lines: 8va (an octave higher than written) and 8vb (an octave lower).

No one reads every note of such a texture at sight. A professional reads the outline (the tune on top and the bass at the bottom) and fills in what the hands can grasp. This unit teaches both: reading big shapes quickly, and simplifying when the page is too full.

What is new

Octaves

Read the top note of an octave and let the hand keep its shape (thumb and fifth finger): the lower note is always the same letter. Move the whole hand from the wrist.

8va and 8vb

8va (or 8) over the staff, with a dashed line, means play an octave higher than written, until the line ends. 8vb (or 8 under the staff) means an octave lower. Read the notes as printed, then move the hand.

Full chords

In a chord of four to six notes the tune is the top note. Read it first, then the bass, then the shape between them (a triad in an octave, a seventh chord).

Wide arpeggios and the pedal

A left hand that rises over two octaves cannot hold its notes: the pedal holds them. Change the pedal with each new chord.

Crossed hands

When a note on the upper staff is marked l.h. (left hand), the left hand crosses over the right to play it, then comes back. Lift it in plenty of time.

Three staves

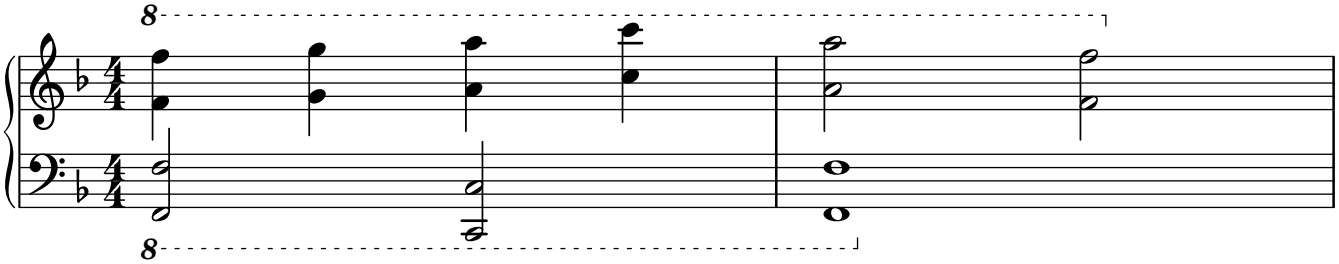
When a passage needs three staves, the right hand usually reads the top one and the left hand the two lower ones (or the other way round). Look for the bracket and the hand marks.

Simplifying at sight

If a texture is too full, keep the tune and the bass and drop the inner notes; keep the rhythm going at all costs. Part C prints a suggested reduction under each exercise.

Octaves under an 8va sign

The right hand plays octaves an octave higher than written; the left hand's octaves are under 8vb, an octave lower than written.



The left hand crosses over

The left hand plays the bass and the chord, then crosses over the right hand for the high note marked l.h.



Reading tips

1. Read the outline first: the tune (top notes) and the bass (bottom notes).

2. Look for 8va and 8vb signs before you play, and where their dashed lines end.

3. Keep the hand's shape for octaves and chords; move it from the wrist and arm.

4. Change the pedal with the harmony, not with the beat.

5. If you cannot play everything, drop inner notes, never the beat.

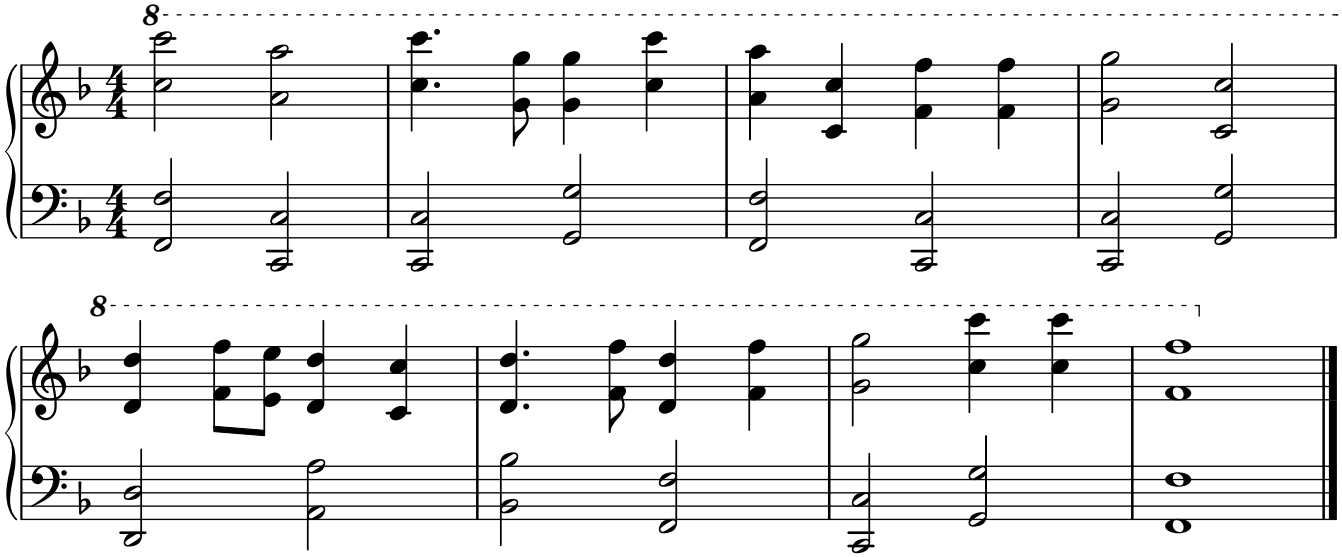
Part A: Octaves, 8va and 8vb ♩= 72

The tune in right-hand octaves over left-hand octaves. Some exercises lie high (under 8va), some low (under 8vb).

☐ **5.1**



☐ **5.2**



☐ **5.3**



5.4



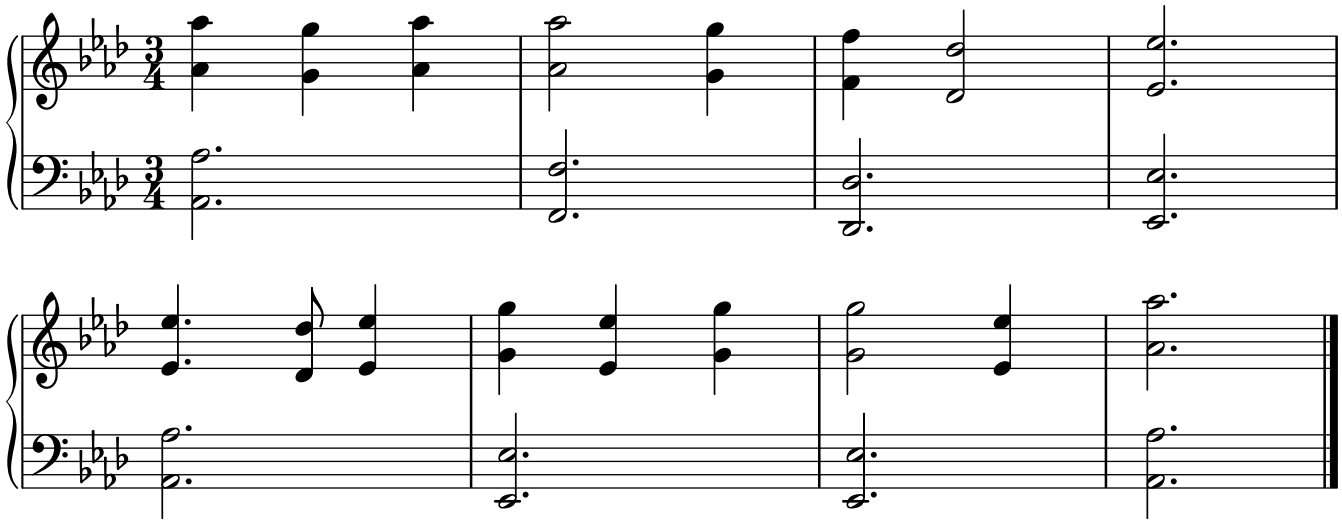
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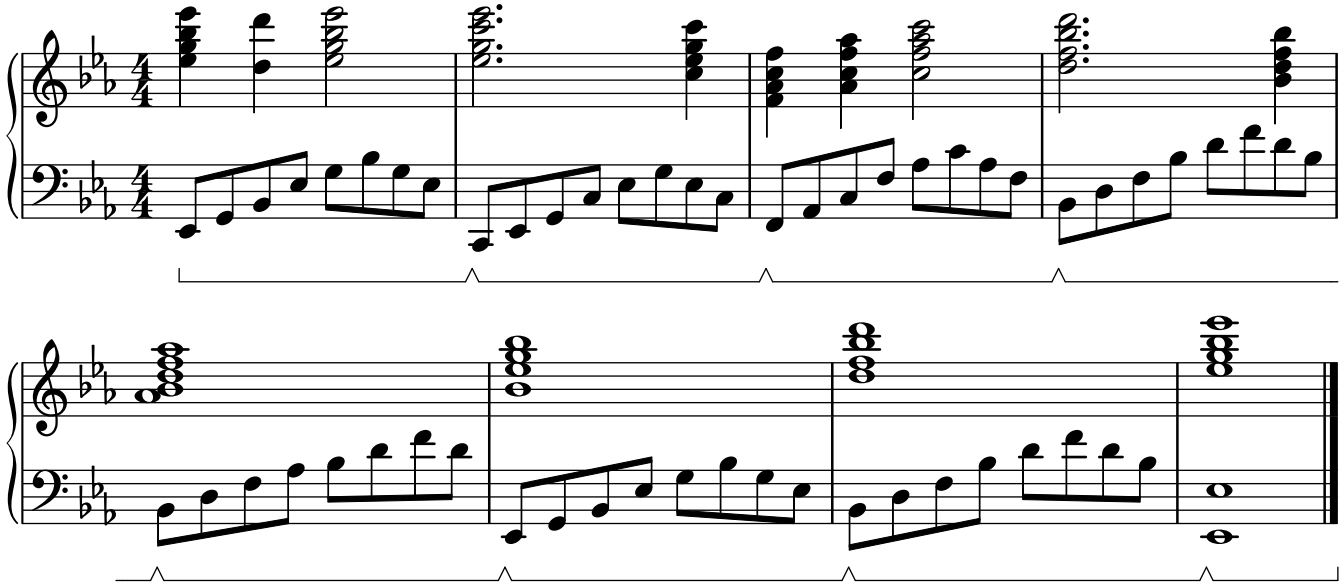
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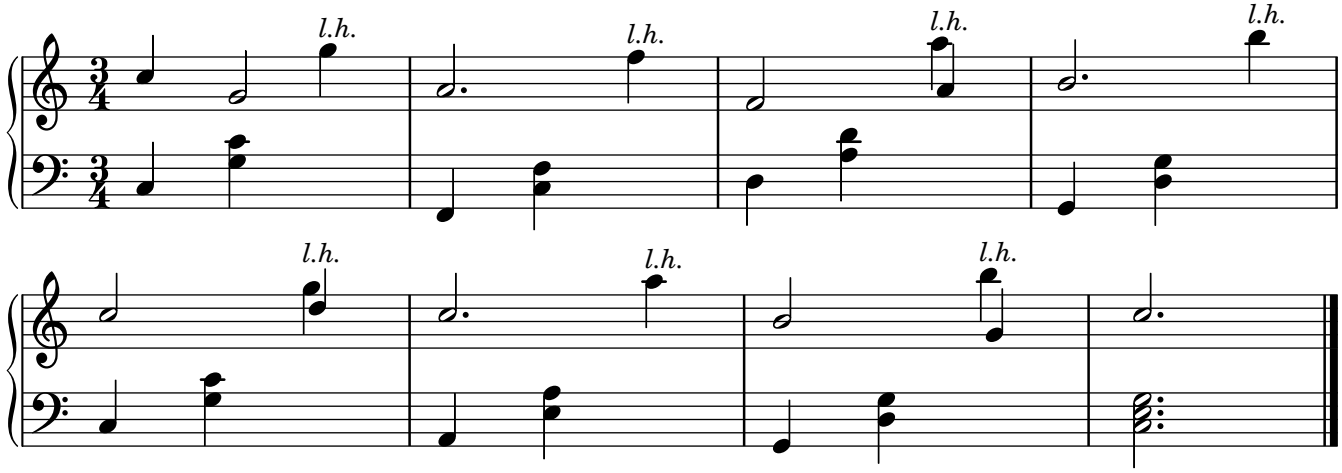
Part B: Full chords, arpeggios and crossed hands ♩ = 60

Full right-hand chords over a left hand that sweeps up an octave and a half with the pedal, alternating with 3/4 exercises in which the left hand crosses over the right on the third beat.

☐ **5.9**



☐ **5.10** ♩ = 72



☐ **5.11**



5.12 ♩ = 72



5.13



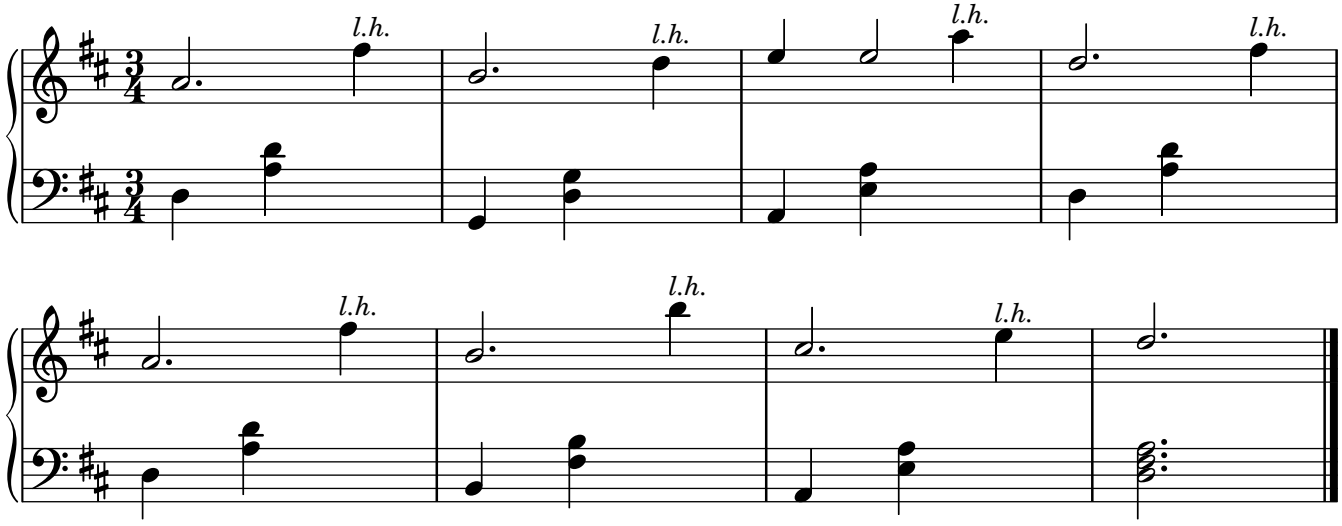
5.14 ♩ = 72



5.15



5.16 ♩ = 72



Part C: Simplifying at sight ♩ = 60

Full chords in both hands. Under each exercise a smaller staff prints the outline: the tune and the bass. Play the full version if you can; if not, play the outline and keep going.

☐ **5.17**



5.18



5.19



5.20



5.21



5.22



5.23



5.24



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Wedding Day at Troldhaugen ♩ = 112

Edvard Grieg (1896), Lyric Pieces Op. 65 No. 6 - bars 1-10

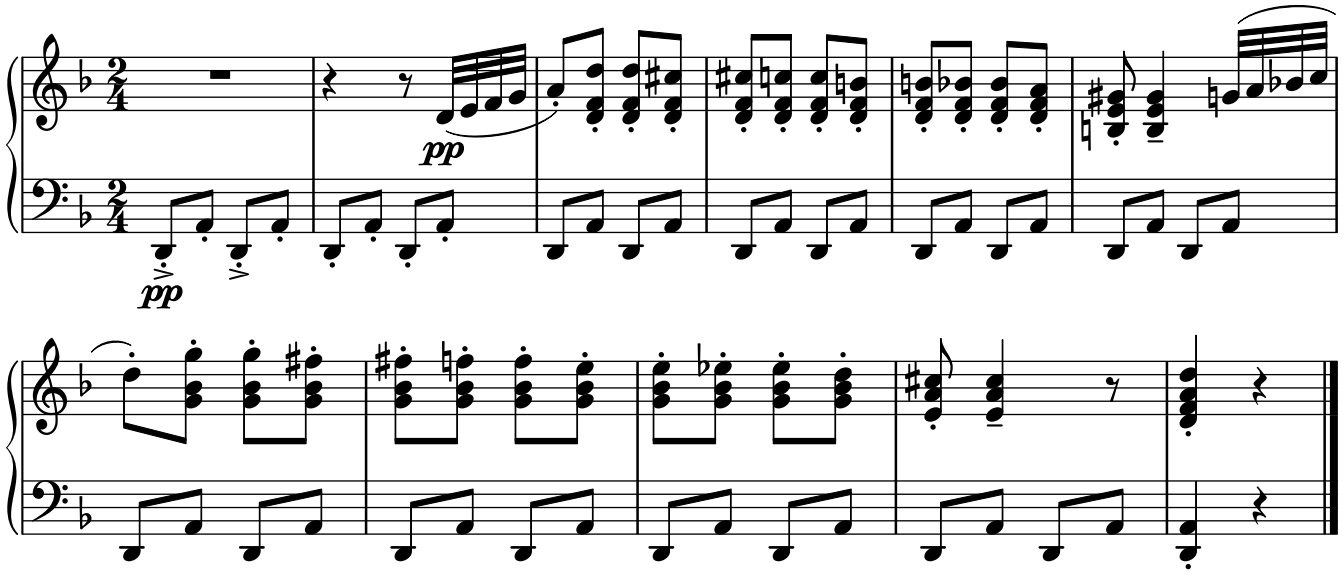
A festive march. The left hand jumps between low and middle open fifths; the right hand starts in the bass clef with the same fifths, then plays the tune with chords and a held lower voice. Accented chords (marked > and staccato) are the march's steps. In bar 10 the left hand jumps two octaves for the last chord. Source: Mutopia Project no. 781 (public domain).



March of the Trolls ♩ = 112

Edvard Grieg (1891), Lyric Pieces Op. 54 No. 3 - bars 1-10, with a closing chord

Very soft and very short (pp, staccato): the trolls creep. The left hand repeats D and A in the bass all through; the right hand's three-note chords slide down by half steps while their two lower notes stay. Each phrase starts with a quick run of four 32nd notes up to the first chord. Grieg's march goes on; the excerpt closes on D minor. Source: Mutopia Project no. 2014 (public domain).



March of the Wooden Soldiers ♩ = 132

Peter Ilyich Tchaikovsky (1878), Children's Album Op. 39 No. 5 - the first strain

Both hands in the treble clef, playing short chords and dotted rhythms like toy drums and fifes. The dotted rhythm (dotted eighth, sixteenth) must be sharp; the rests are as important as the notes. The strain moves from D major to A major in bar 16. Source: Mutopia Project no. 1806 (public domain).



Bells ♩ = 52

Original, written for this book

Three staves. The right hand reads the top staff: bells in octaves, printed under 8va (an octave higher than written). The left hand reads both lower staves: the deep octave on the first beat (the bottom staff, under 8vb: an octave lower than written), then the chords on the second, third and fourth beats (the middle staff). Use the pedal in every bar: it holds the deep bass under the chords. The texture is modelled on the opening of Rachmaninoff's Prelude in C-sharp minor.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 6?

- Play two new exercises from each part at the speeds shown, with no more than one stop each.
- Pass if every 8va and 8vb passage is played in the right octave and the crossed-hand notes come on time.
- Pass if you can play Part C's exercises in full or in outline without stopping, and the Wedding Day at Troldhaugen excerpt after a few days.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 6.

Unit 6

Accompanying

New: Three staves: a singer's line above the piano; introductions and interludes; following the soloist

Most pianists who read at sight do it for someone else: a singer, a violinist, a choir. The score then has three staves: the soloist's line on top (smaller, or with words under it) and the two piano staves below. The pianist plays the piano part and reads the soloist's line at the same time, to know where the music is going, to breathe with the soloist, and to wait at a pause.

In this unit the singer's line is sung to "la" in the exercises, and to the poet's words in the songs. Read the top line as part of the music, not as decoration: it is the tune your accompaniment supports.

What is new

The soloist's staff

The top staff, joined to the piano by a bar line or a separate bracket, is the soloist's. The piano's two staves are joined by the brace. Your hands play only the braced staves; your eyes read all three.

Introductions and interludes

When the soloist rests, the piano leads: the introduction sets the speed and the mood, an interlude joins two phrases. Play them in time, and give the soloist a clear beat to come in on.

After-beats

A bass note on the beat and chords on the off-beats (oom-pah, oom-pah-pah) keep a song moving. Keep the chords light and the bass clear.

Doubling the tune

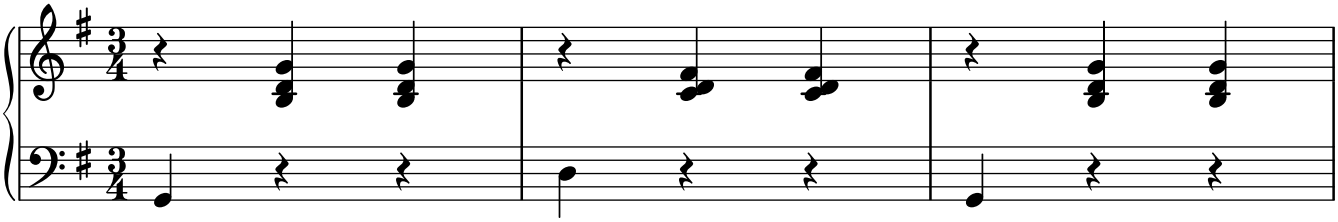
In some bars the piano's top note plays the singer's tune; in others it does not. Where it doubles, play it gently: the singer has it already.

Following the soloist

At a pause (fermata) in the voice, the pianist waits and watches; a rest in the voice is counted exactly. Breathe with the singer at the ends of phrases.

An introduction, then an after-beat accompaniment

Two bars of piano set the speed; the voice (top line in the songs) comes in on bar 3. Bass on the beat, chords after it.



Reading tips

1. Before you play, read the soloist's line: where does it rest, where does it pause, where is its high note?

2. Count the soloist's rests aloud in your head; come in with the soloist, not after.

3. Keep the accompaniment softer than the tune: the singer must be heard.

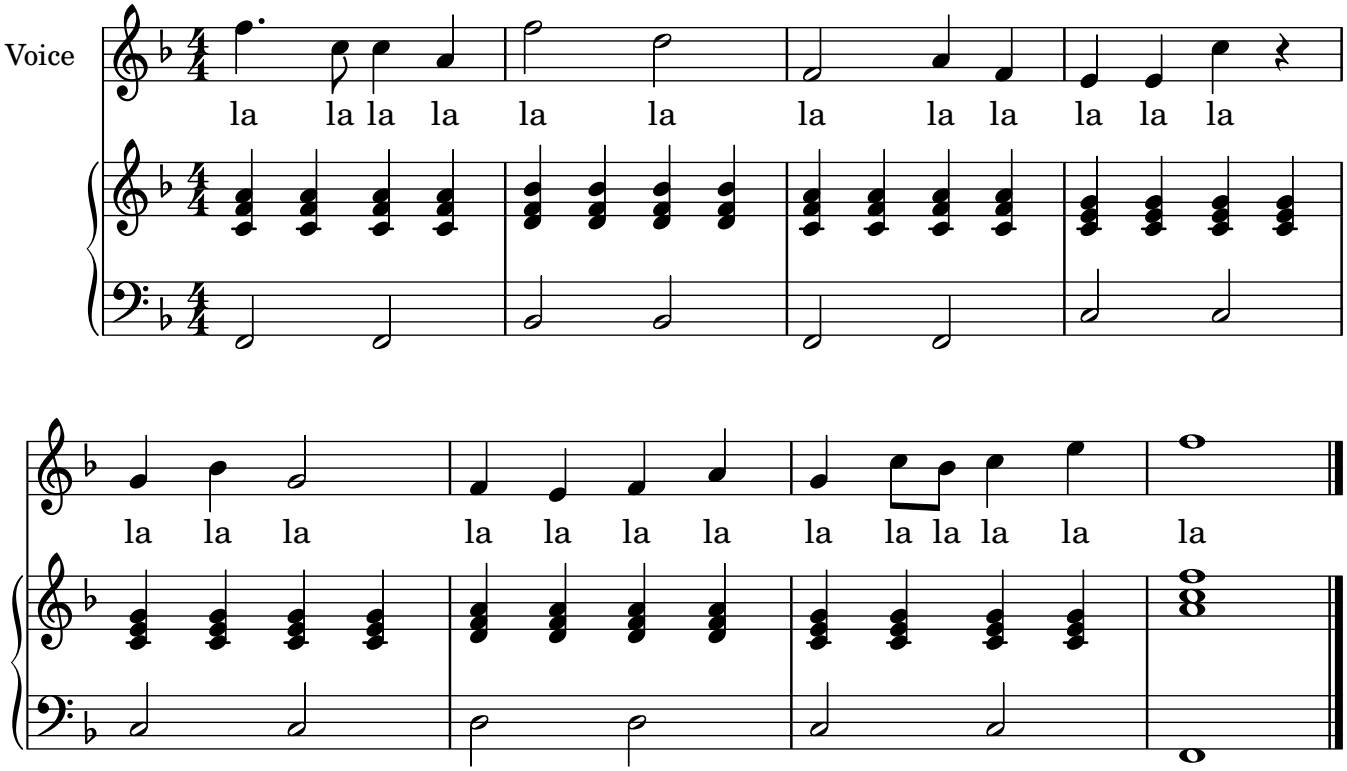
4. At a fermata in the voice, hold your chord and watch for the next breath.

5. If you must simplify, keep the bass and the rhythm of the accompaniment; drop inner notes.

Part A: A singer's line over block chords ♩ = 72

A singer's line (sung to "la") above block chords on every beat, the bass in long notes. 4/4 and 3/4. The singer breathes (a quarter rest) in bar 4.

☐ **6.1**



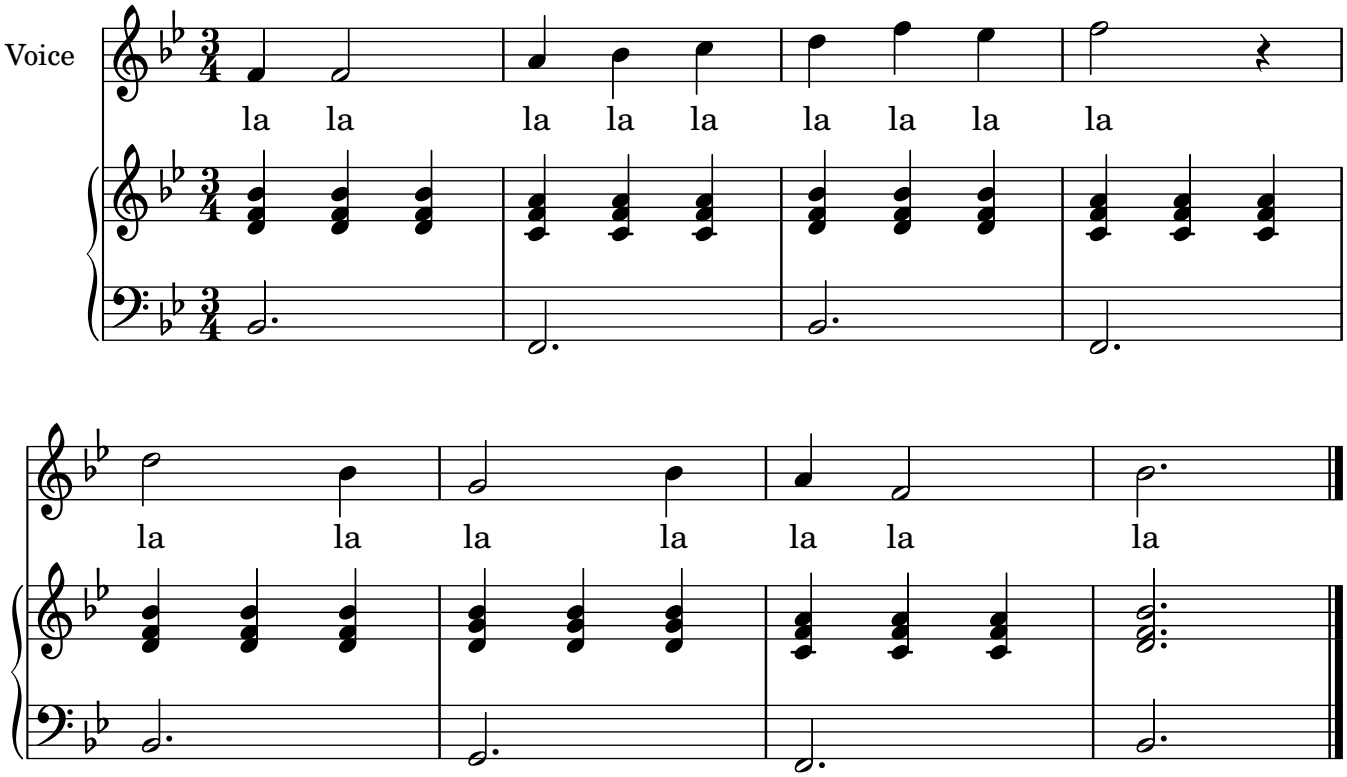
☐ **6.2** ♩ = 88



6.3


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la la la

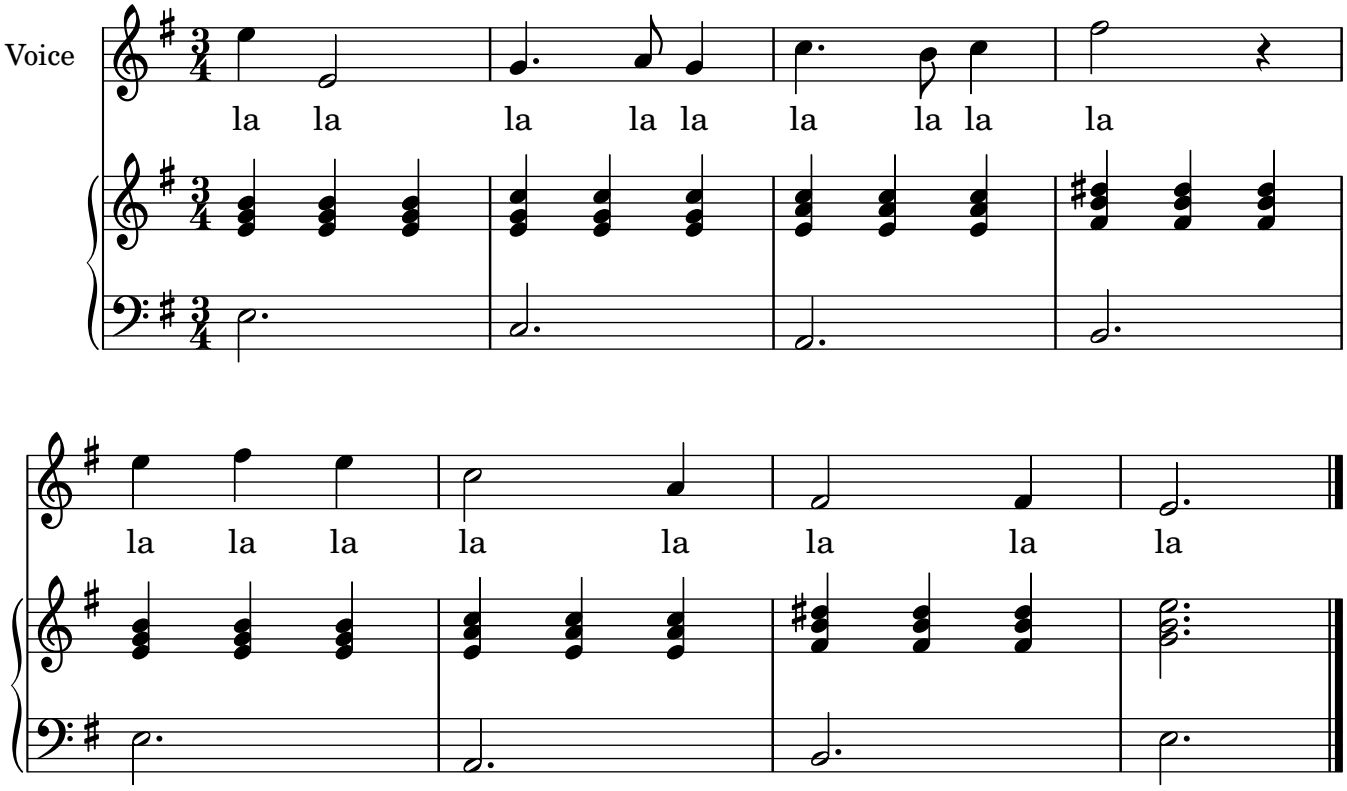
6.4 ♩ = 88


Voice
la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la

6.5


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la la la la

6.6 ♩ = 88


Voice
la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la

6.7


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la

6.8 ♩ = 88


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la

Part B: Introductions, interludes and after-beats ♩ = 88

Two bars of piano introduction, the first phrase, a bar of piano interlude, the second phrase.
3/4 exercises use an after-beat accompaniment, 4/4 exercises broken chords in eighths.

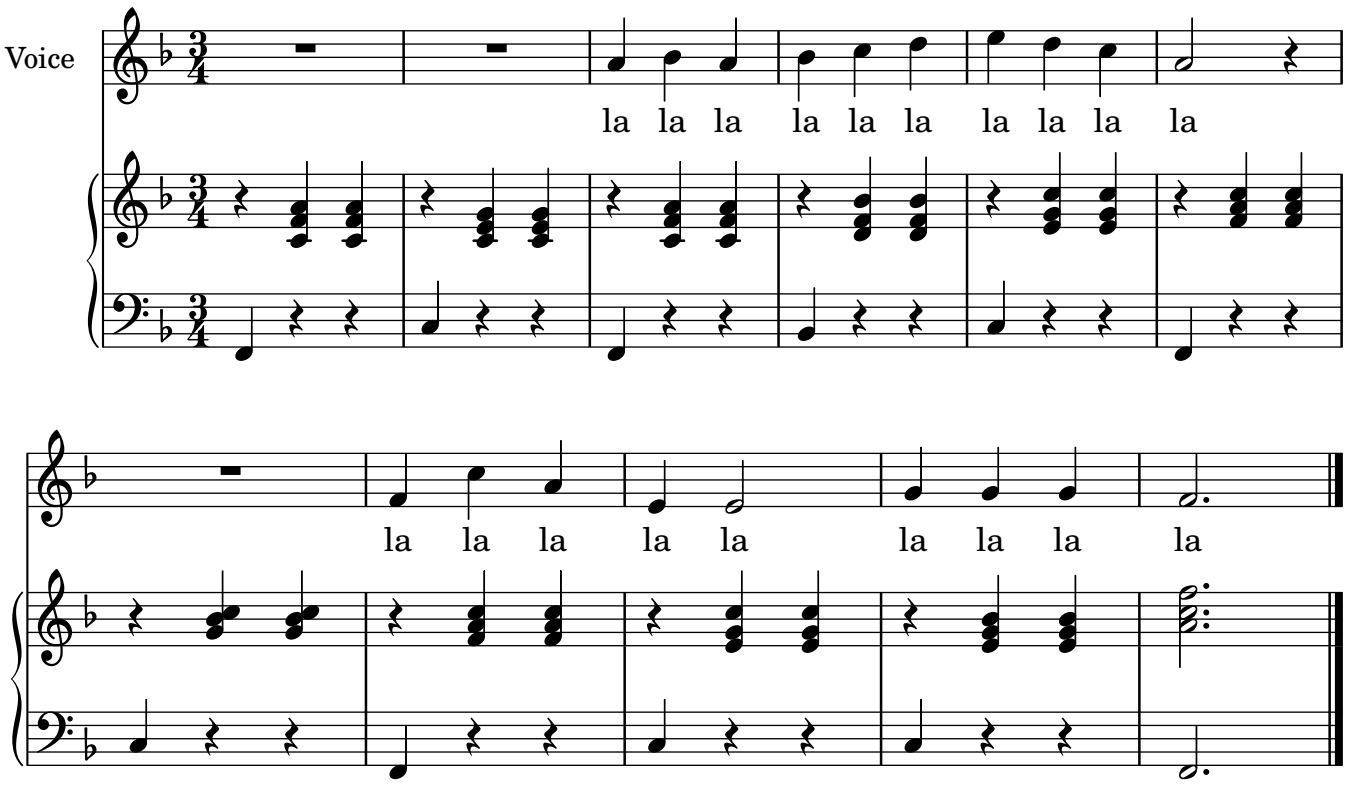
6.9



6.10 ♩ = 66



6.11


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la

6.12 ♩ = 66


Voice
la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la la la la la

6.13


Voice
la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la

6.14 ♩ = 66


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la la

6.15


Voice
la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la

6.16 ♩ = 66


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la

Part C: Doubling the tune; counting the rests

♩ = 72

In bars 3-4 and 7-8 of the singer's line the piano's right hand doubles the tune; in the other bars it plays chords. A bar of interlude in the middle: count the singer's rests.

☐ **6.17**



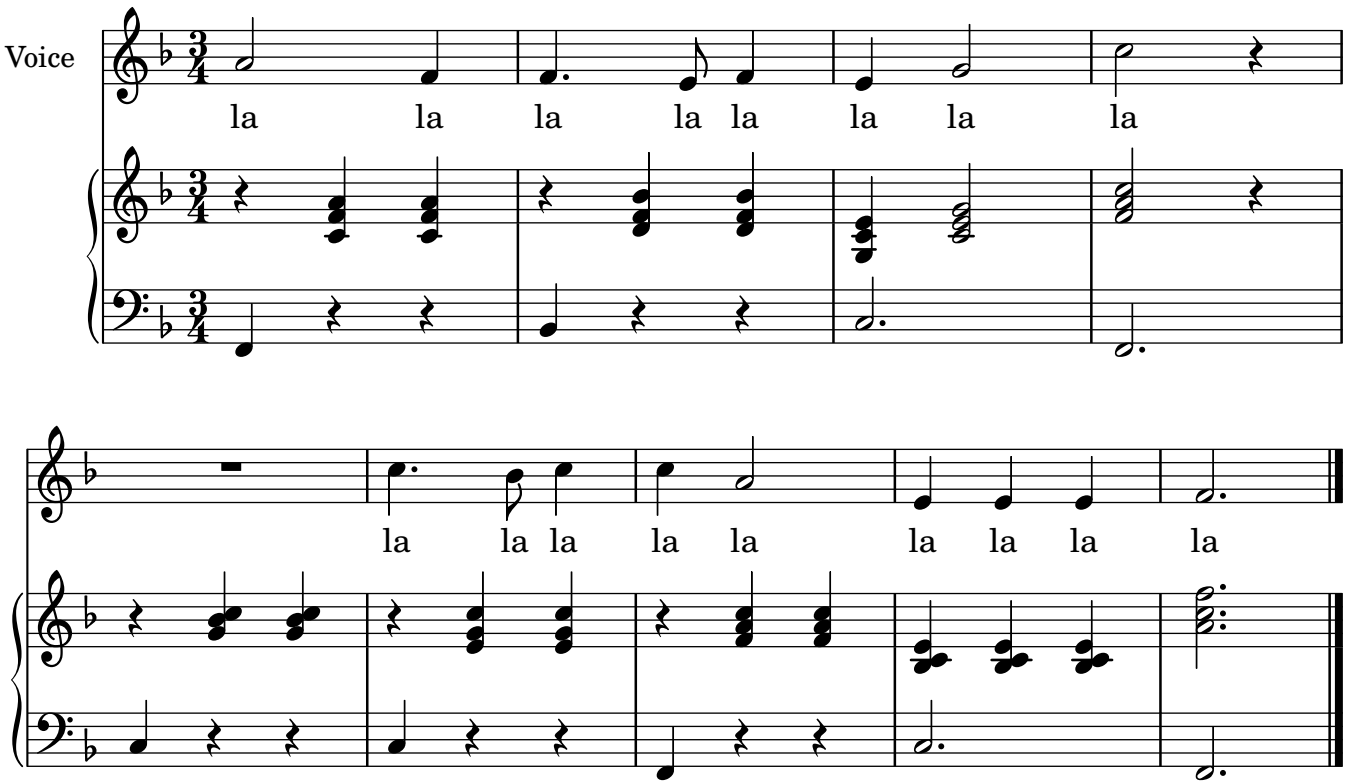
☐ **6.18** ♩ = 88



6.19


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la la la la

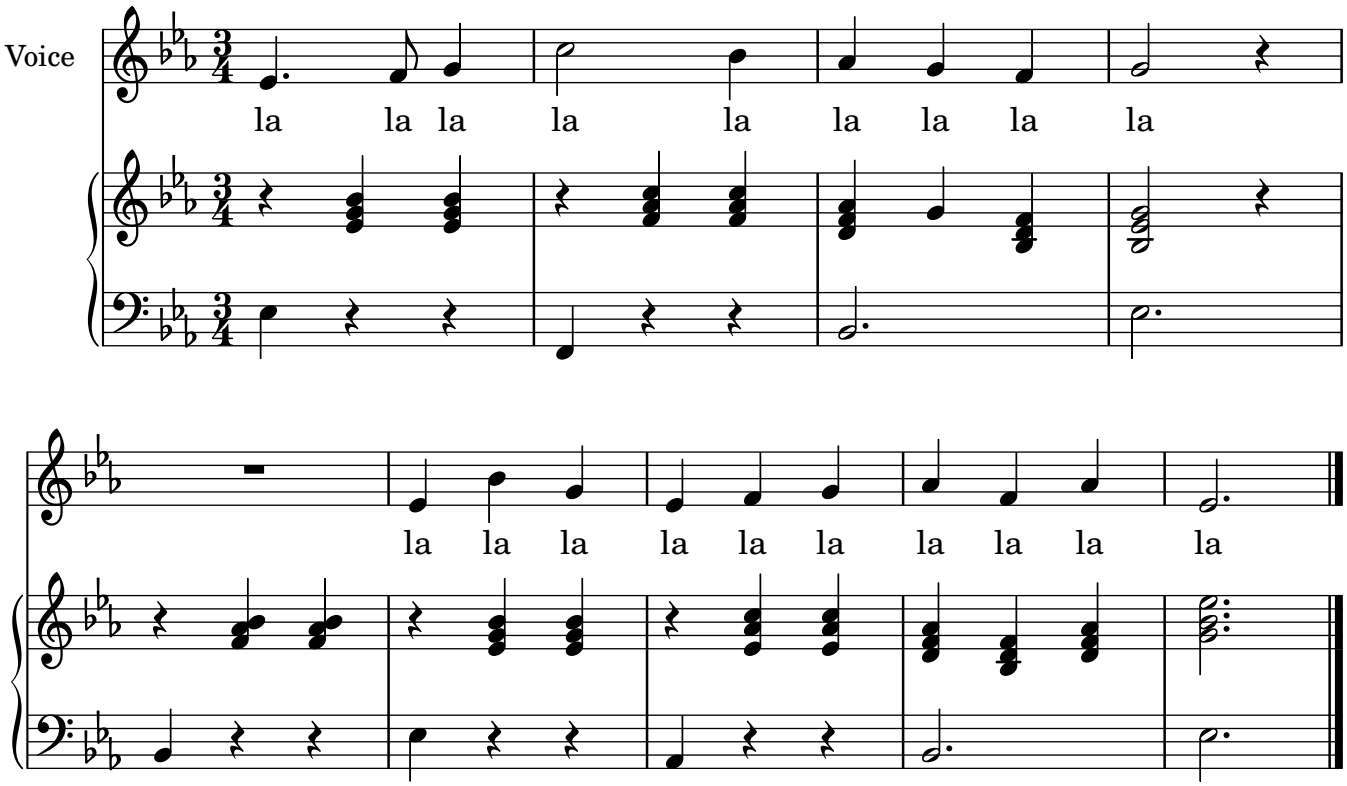
6.20 ♩ = 88


Voice
la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la

6.21


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la la la

6.22 ♩ = 88


Voice
la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la

6.23


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la la la

6.24 ♩ = 88


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la

Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Heidenroslein ♩ = 69

Franz Schubert (1815), Heidenroslein D. 257 (words by Goethe) - the first verse

A singer's line over a light after-beat accompaniment (rests on the beat, chords after it). The singer's paired sixteenths (beamed together) carry one syllable each. Bars 10 and 12 have pauses: the piano waits for the singer. The last two bars are the piano's postlude, with two grace notes. Words: "A boy saw a little rose on the heath ..." Source: Mutopia Project no. 1555 (public domain).

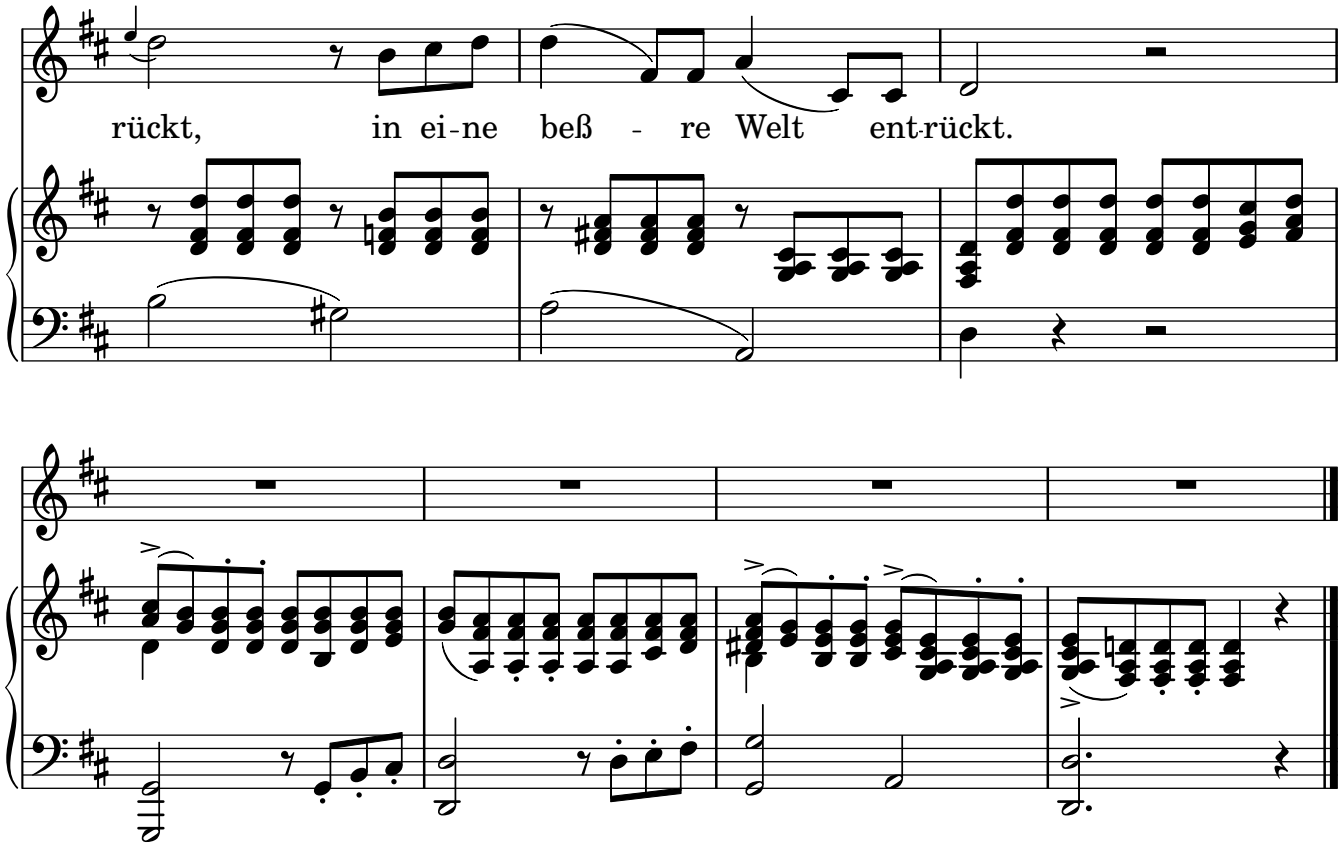


An die Musik ♩ = 36

Franz Schubert (1817), An die Musik D. 547 (words by Franz von Schober) - the first verse

"To music": a hymn of thanks. The piano's right hand repeats its chords in eighths while the left hand's bass line sings against the voice (in bars 7-18 it moves in long notes, often by half steps). Two bars of introduction; the voice rests in bar 10 (count it) and the piano closes the verse alone. Words: "You lovely art, in how many grey hours ... you have carried me into a better world." Source: Mutopia Project no. 1001 (public domain).




rückt, in ei-ne beß - re Welt ent-rückt.

Ich liebe dich ♩ = 60

Edvard Grieg (1864), Ich liebe dich Op. 5 No. 3 (German words by F. von Holstein) - the verse, from bar 3

"I love you": a romantic song in which the piano breathes with the singer. The right hand's chords move in eighths, the left hand sings its own line (bars 2 and 9) and holds long basses with the pedal. From bar 11 the music grows (cresc. sempre) to the top of the phrase in bar 15; then a short ritardando. The excerpt starts with the singer's first upbeat and ends with the song's last bar. Source: Mutopia Project no. 586 (public domain).




ff
lie - be dich in Zeit und E - wigkeit!
Ich lie - be dich in Zeit und E - wigkeit!

Evening Song ♩= 66

Original, written for this book

A song for a singer and a pianist, to be played with a friend if you can (or sing the top line while you play). Two bars of introduction in broken chords; the singer comes in on bar 3. In bar 8 the singer holds a pause (fermata): the pianist holds the chord, watches, and starts bar 9 with the singer's next breath.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 7?

- Play two new exercises from each part at the speed shown, with no more than one stop each, reading the singer's line as you go.
- Pass if every introduction and interlude is in time, and you can say at any moment which word or note the singer has reached.
- Pass if you can play Heidenroslein and the Evening Song at sight (with a singer if possible), and An die Musik after a few days.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 7.

Unit 7

Open Score, C Clefs and Transposing

New: Four staves (SATB), the vocal tenor clef, the alto and tenor clefs; transposing at sight

Choir directors, organists and rehearsal pianists play from scores that were not written for the piano: four voices on four staves (open score), or a string quartet with its viola part in the alto clef. The pianist reads the staves together and plays them with two hands: soprano and alto in the right hand, tenor and bass in the left.
Two skills make this possible. First, new clefs: the treble clef with an 8 below (the tenor voice), and the C clefs, whose middle points to middle C. Second, transposing at sight: playing a tune in a different key from the one it is printed in, by reading intervals and shapes instead of note names.

What is new

Open score

Each voice has its own staff, top to bottom: soprano, alto, tenor, bass. Take the top two with the right hand and the bottom two with the left. Read down each beat (the chord), then along each line (the voices).

The tenor's clef

A treble clef with a small 8 below it means: an octave lower than written. The tenor's notes look like the alto's but sound an octave lower, in the left hand's range.

The alto clef

A C clef on the middle line: that line is middle C. The viola reads it. Its lines, from bottom to top, are F, A, C, E, G: each note sits one step below where it would be in the treble clef.

The tenor clef

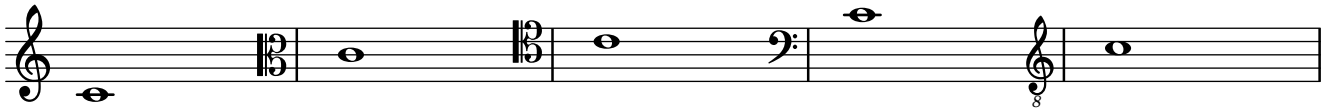
A C clef on the fourth line from the bottom: that line is middle C. Cellos, bassoons and trombones read it for high notes. Its lines are D, F, A, C, E.

Transposing at sight

To play a tune a tone higher, change the key signature in your head (F major becomes G major), then read the notes as a pattern of steps and leaps, starting a tone higher. Do not rename every note: follow the shape.

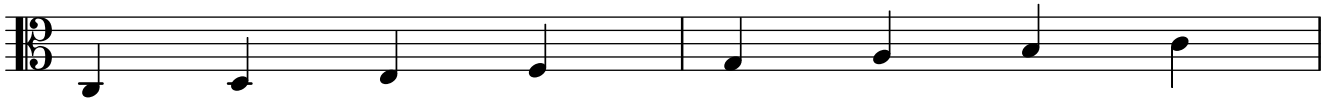
Middle C in five clefs

The same note, middle C, in the treble, alto, tenor and bass clefs, and the tenor voice's treble-8 clef (where a C on the third space sounds as middle C).



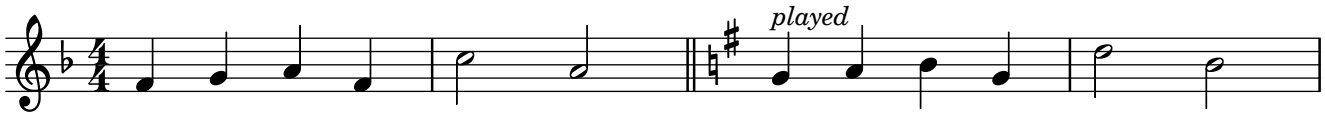
A scale in the alto clef

C major from the C below middle C up to middle C, as the viola reads it.



Transposing a tone up

Printed in F major; played in G major: every note a tone higher. The shape (step, step, leap of a third ...) stays the same.



Reading tips

1. Name the clef of every staff before you start, and find middle C in each.

2. In open score, play soprano and alto with the right hand, tenor and bass with the left; read down the beat.

3. If four staves are too many, play the outer voices first (soprano and bass), then add the others.

4. When transposing, say the new key and its sharps or flats aloud, then read by intervals.

5. The answers to Part C are at the back of the book (in the full volume): play first, check afterwards.

Part A: Four voices on four staves ♩ = 60

Four-part chorales on four staves: soprano and alto in the treble clef, the tenor in the treble clef with an 8 below (an octave lower than written), the bass in the bass clef. Play them on the piano.

☐ **7.1**



7.2



7.3



☐ **7.4**



☐ **7.5**



☐ **7.6**



☐ **7.7**



☐ **7.8**



Part B: String quartet and the C clefs ♩= 60

String quartet scores (violins, viola in the alto clef, cello) alternating with chorales printed in the old way: the alto in the alto clef and the tenor in the tenor clef.

☐ **7.9**



7.10



7.11



7.12



7.13



7.14



7.15



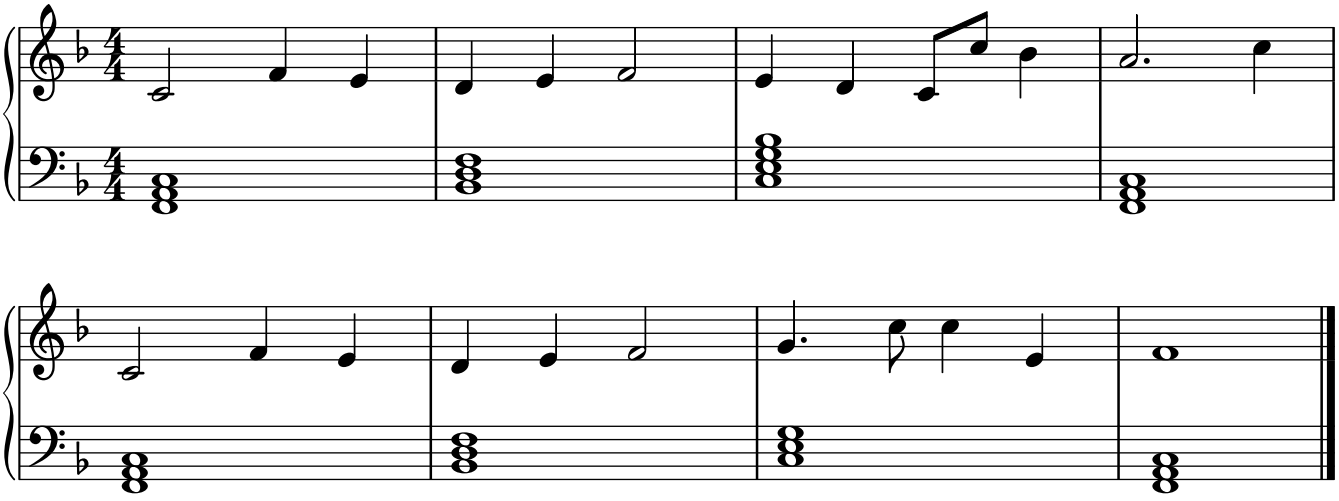
7.16



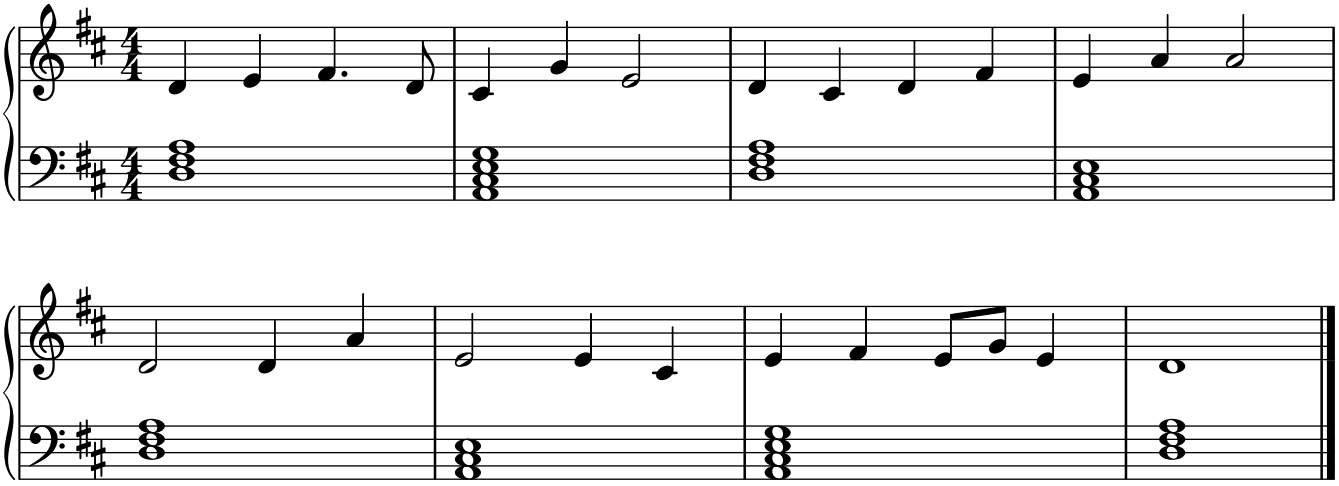
Part C: Transposing at sight ♩ = 60

Play each tune in the key named above it: a tone (or a minor third) higher or lower than printed. The answers, written out, are at the back of the book.

☐ **7.17** *Play it a tone higher: in G major*



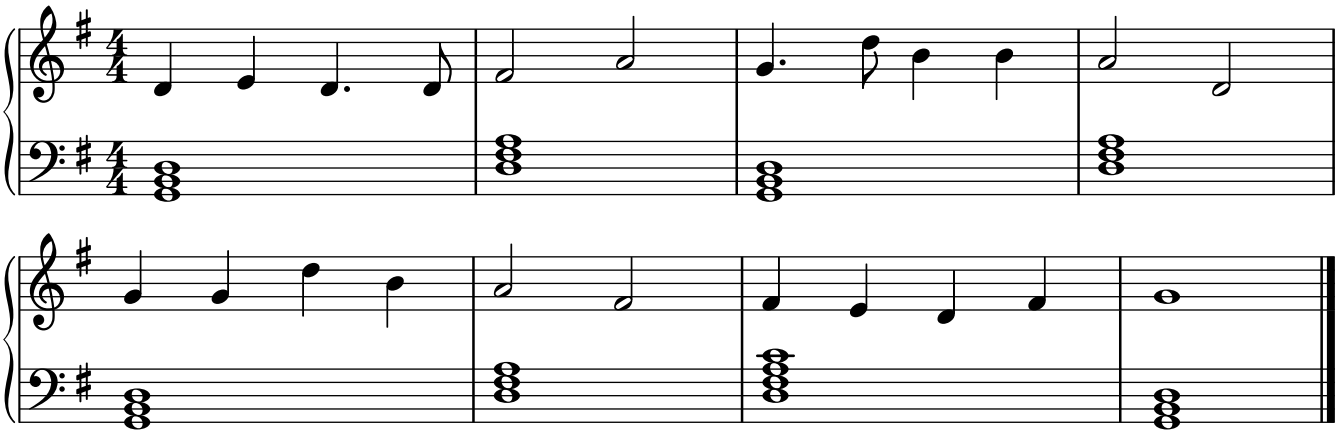
☐ **7.18** *Play it a tone lower: in C major*



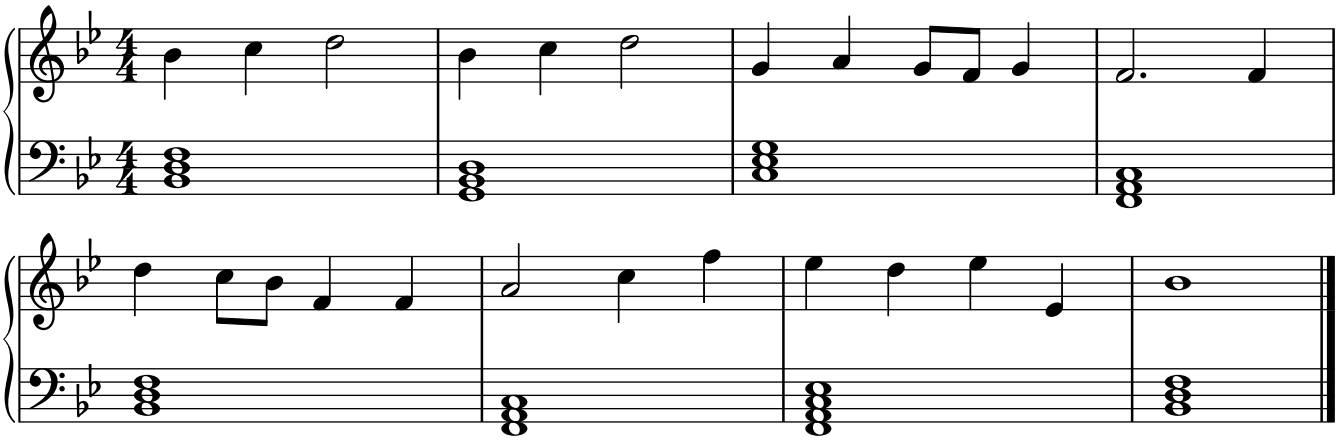
☐ **7.19** *Play it a tone higher: in D major*



☐ **7.20** *Play it a tone lower: in F major*



☐ **7.21** *Play it a tone higher: in C major*



☐ **7.22** *Play it a tone lower: in G major*



☐ **7.23** *Play it a minor third higher: in E-flat major*



☐ **7.24** *Play it a minor third lower: in E major*



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

If ye love me ♩ = 72

Thomas Tallis (1565), If ye love me - the first section

An anthem for four voices: "If ye love me, keep my commandments". The four lines move mostly together, but in bars 5-9 they enter one after another (soprano, then alto, tenor and bass). The tenor's staff is an octave lower than written. Play soprano and alto with the right hand, tenor and bass with the left. Source: Mutopia Project no. 412 (public domain).



O nata lux

𝅗𝅥 = 66

Thomas Tallis (1575), O nata lux de lumine - the first and last phrases

Five voices (Superius, Discantus, Contratenor, Tenor, Bassus), the top two in the treble clef, the middle two in the tenor's treble-8 clef, and the bass. Count three half notes in a bar; the music starts on an upbeat of three quarters. The first phrase ends in bar 4; the excerpt then jumps to Tallis's last phrase, which ends on a G major chord (the B natural in the Discantus and Tenor). The small accidentals of the source (added by the editor) are printed as normal ones here. Source: Mutopia Project no. 949 (public domain).



Emperor Quartet: the theme

♩ = 40

Joseph Haydn (1797), String Quartet Op. 76 No. 3, second movement - the theme

Haydn's hymn (now the German national anthem) in a string quartet. The first violin has the tune, the second violin a lower voice, the viola (alto clef: the middle line is middle C) and the cello the harmony. The phrase in bars 12-15 is repeated in bars 16-19 (fz: a sudden accent). Play violins with the right hand, viola and cello with the left. Source: Mutopia Project no. 385 (public domain).



Chorale in the C Clefs ♩ = 60

Original, written for this book

A chorale printed as choirs and organists once read it: the alto in the alto clef (the middle line is middle C) and the tenor in the tenor clef (the fourth line is middle C). Name the first note of each voice before you play. Then play it again a tone higher, in C major.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 8?

- Play two new exercises from each part at the speed shown, with no more than one stop each.
- Pass if you read every clef without stopping to work out the notes, and your transpositions match the answers at the back of the book.
- Pass if you can play the Emperor theme at sight and If ye love me after a few days.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 8.

Unit 8

Lead Sheets, Simplifying and Review

New: Chord symbols (C, Am7, G7/B, Fmaj7, Bdim, C/E); playing from a lead sheet; review

Much of the music a pianist is handed is not written out at all: a tune with chord symbols above it, a "lead sheet". Hymnals, folk-song books, musicals and jazz standards all use them. The pianist plays the tune (or lets a singer have it) and makes the accompaniment from the symbols.

This last unit teaches you to read chord symbols as fast as notes, and ends the course with a review: one exercise of each kind from this volume, and the opening of one of the best-loved piano pieces ever written.

What is new

Chord symbols

A letter names the chord's root: C is C major (C E G). A small m makes it minor (Am: A C E). 7 adds the minor seventh above the root (G7: G B D F); maj7 adds the major seventh (Cmaj7: C E G B); m7 is a minor chord with a minor seventh (Dm7: D F A C). 6 adds the sixth (C6: C E G A).

Slash chords

A letter after a slash is the bass note: G7/B is G7 with B in the bass; C/E is C major with E in the bass. Play the bass note with the left hand and the chord above it.

Realising a lead sheet

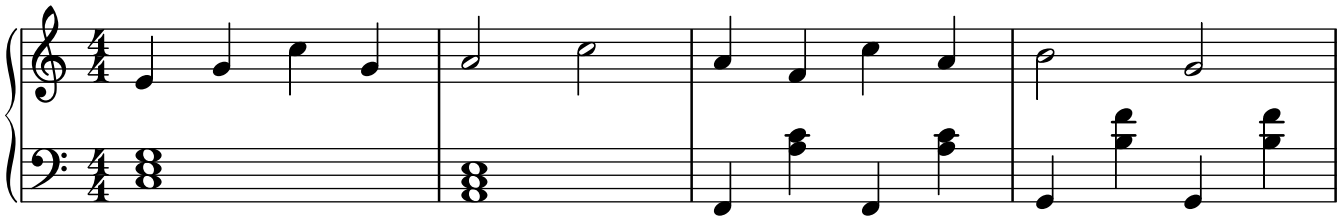
Start simple: the left hand plays the chord in root position, one per bar, while the right hand plays the tune. Then break the chord up: bass note and chord (oom-pah), or a broken chord (root, fifth, tenth). Keep the left hand below the tune.

Simplifying, again

If a passage is too hard at sight, keep the tune and the bass and drop the inner notes (Unit 5). Keep the beat going: a simple version in time is better than a full version that stops.

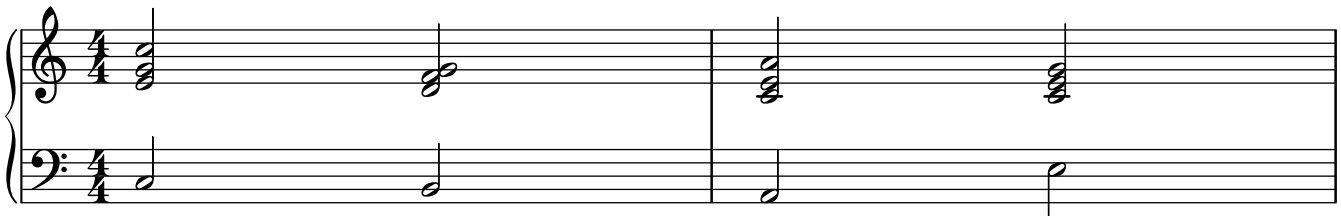
One lead sheet, three ways

The symbols C, Am, F and G7. Bars 1-2: the left hand plays each chord in root position; bars 3-4: bass note and chord (oom-pah).



Slash chords

C, G7/B (B in the bass), Am, C/E: the bass line falls and rises by step under the chords.



Reading tips

1. Before you play, read the chord symbols of the whole lead sheet aloud: "C, A minor, F, G seven".
2. Play the bass note of every symbol first (the root, or the note after the slash).
3. Find the chords near each other: Am after C keeps two notes, G7 after C keeps one.
4. Keep the left hand's accompaniment simple and steady; the tune is what the listener follows.
5. In the review, name the skill each exercise practises before you start.

Part A: Lead sheets: triads ♩ = 72

Lead sheets with major and minor chords. Play the tune with the right hand and each chord in root position with the left; then play them again with a bass note and the chord (oom-pah or oom-pah-pah).

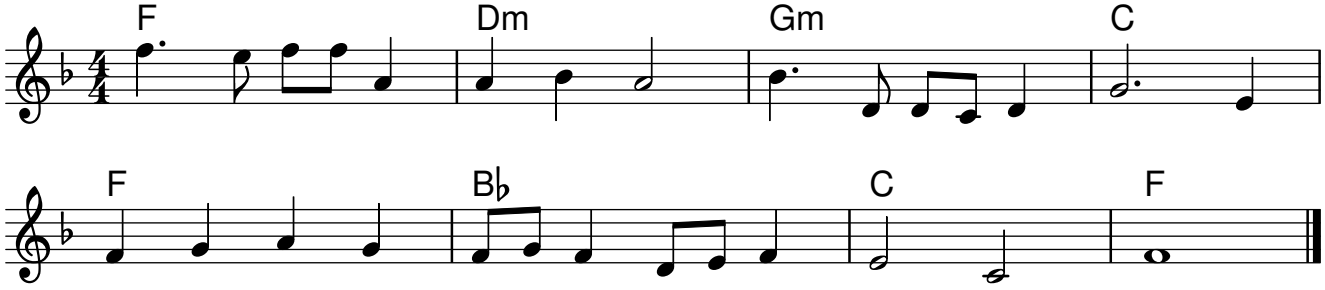
☐ **8.1**



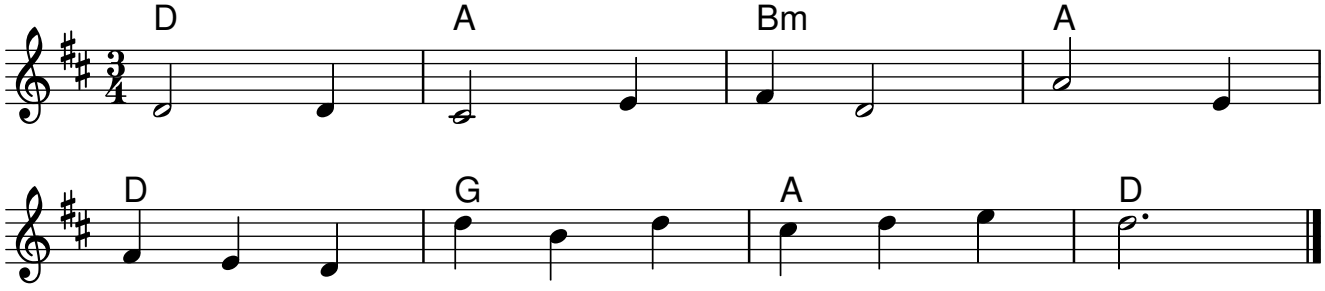
☐ **8.2**



☐ **8.3**



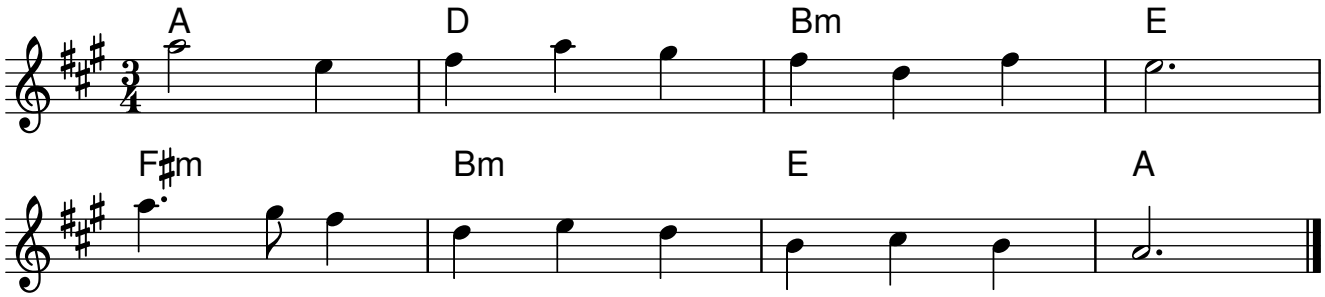
☐ **8.4**



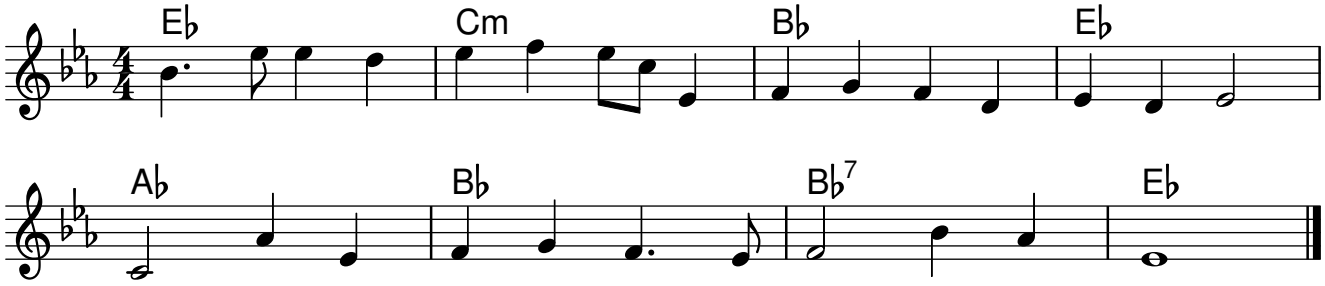
☐ **8.5**



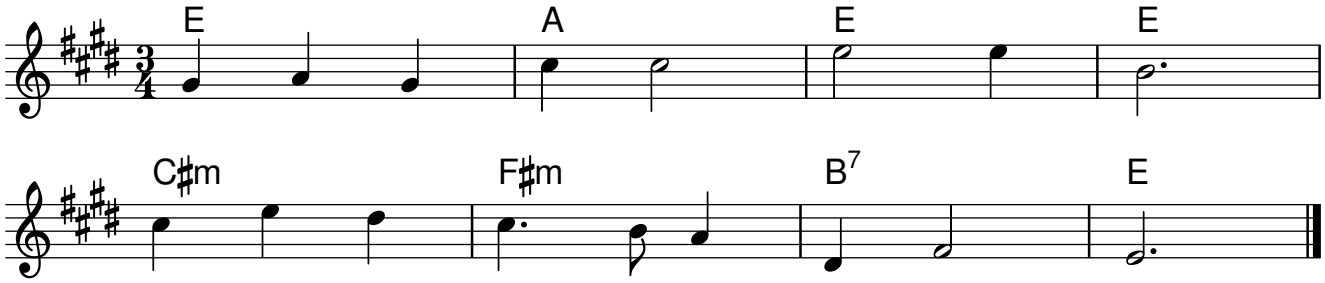
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8.7



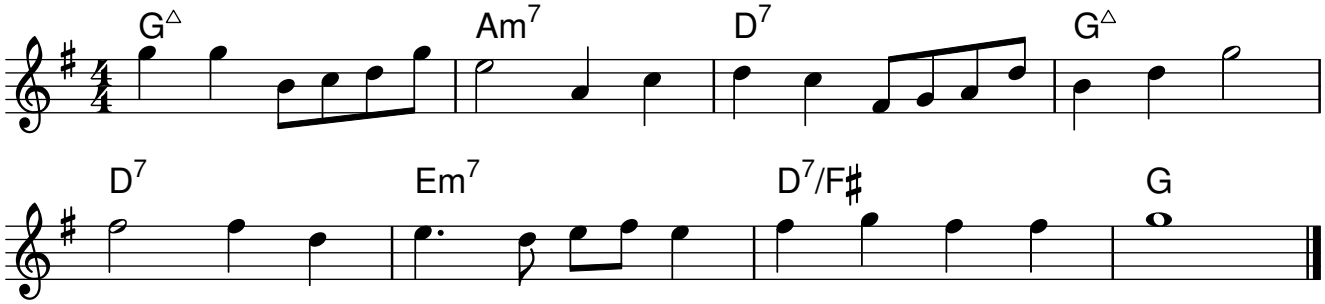
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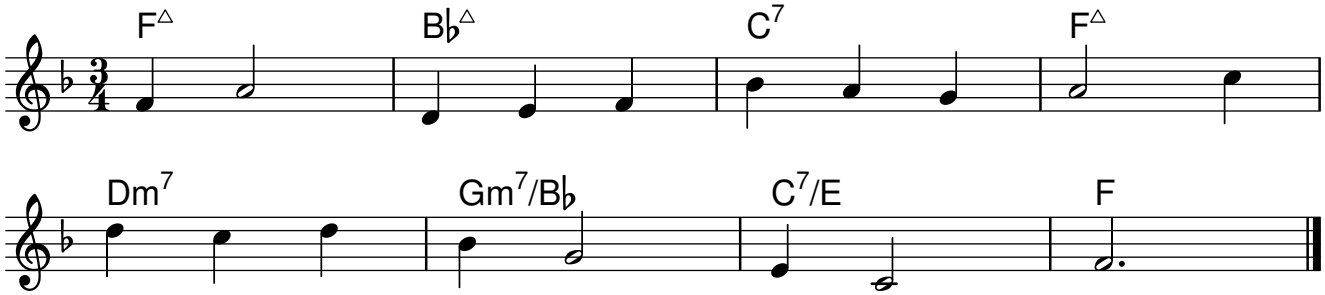
Part B: Lead sheets: sevenths and slash chords ♩ = 72

Lead sheets with seventh chords and slash chords. Choose an accompaniment pattern (block chords, oom-pah, broken chords) and keep it all through.

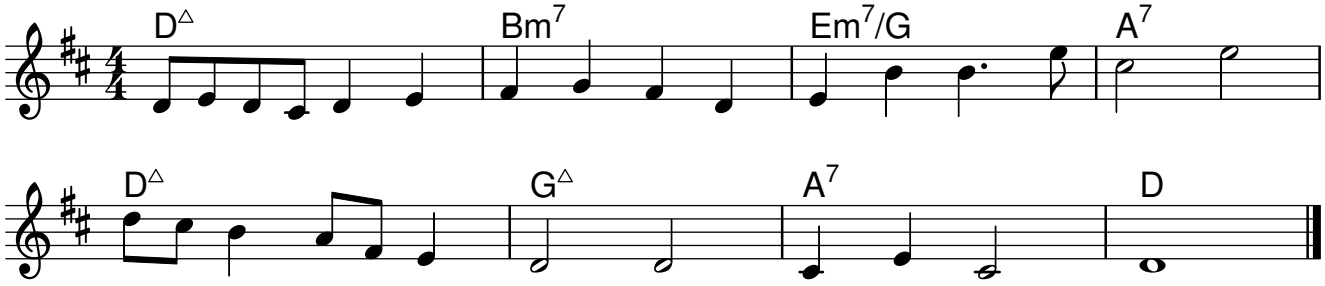
☐ **8.9**



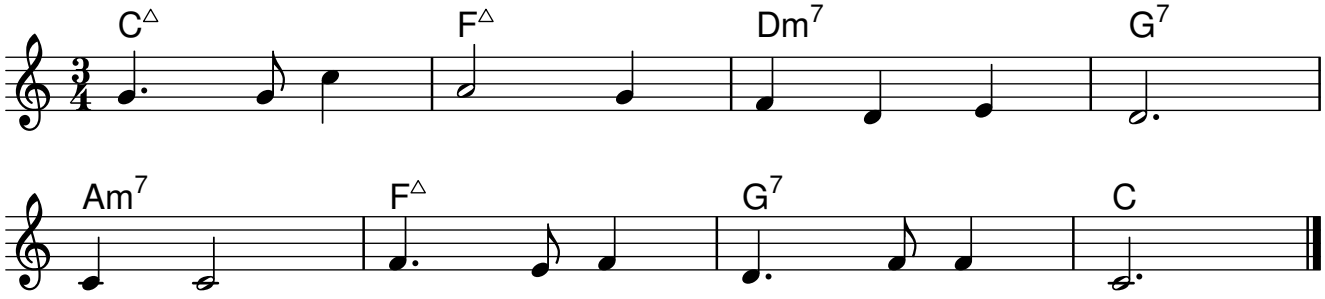
☐ **8.10**



☐ **8.11**



☐ **8.12**



☐ **8.13**



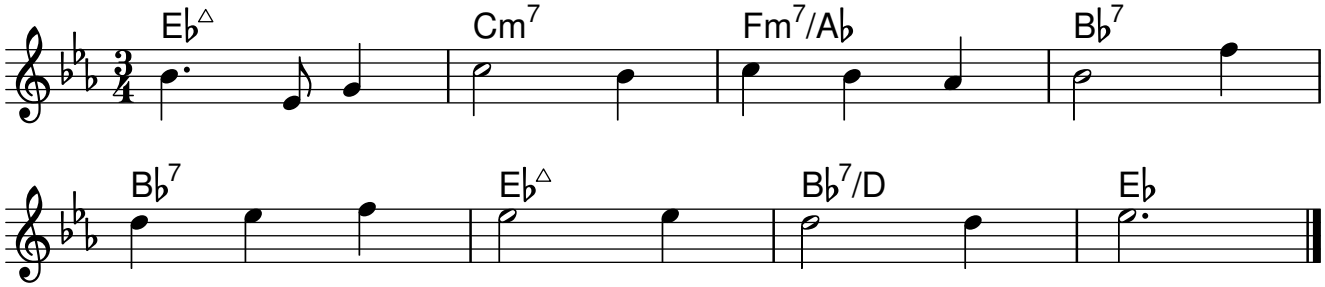
8.14



8.15



8.16



Part C: Review: one of each ♩ = 60

Review: one exercise of each kind from this volume: the middle voice changing hands, a hemiola, 7/8, secondary dominants, octaves, a song, a string quartet and a fugue exposition.

☐ **8.17**



☐ **8.18** ♩ = 96



☐ **8.19** ♪ = 160



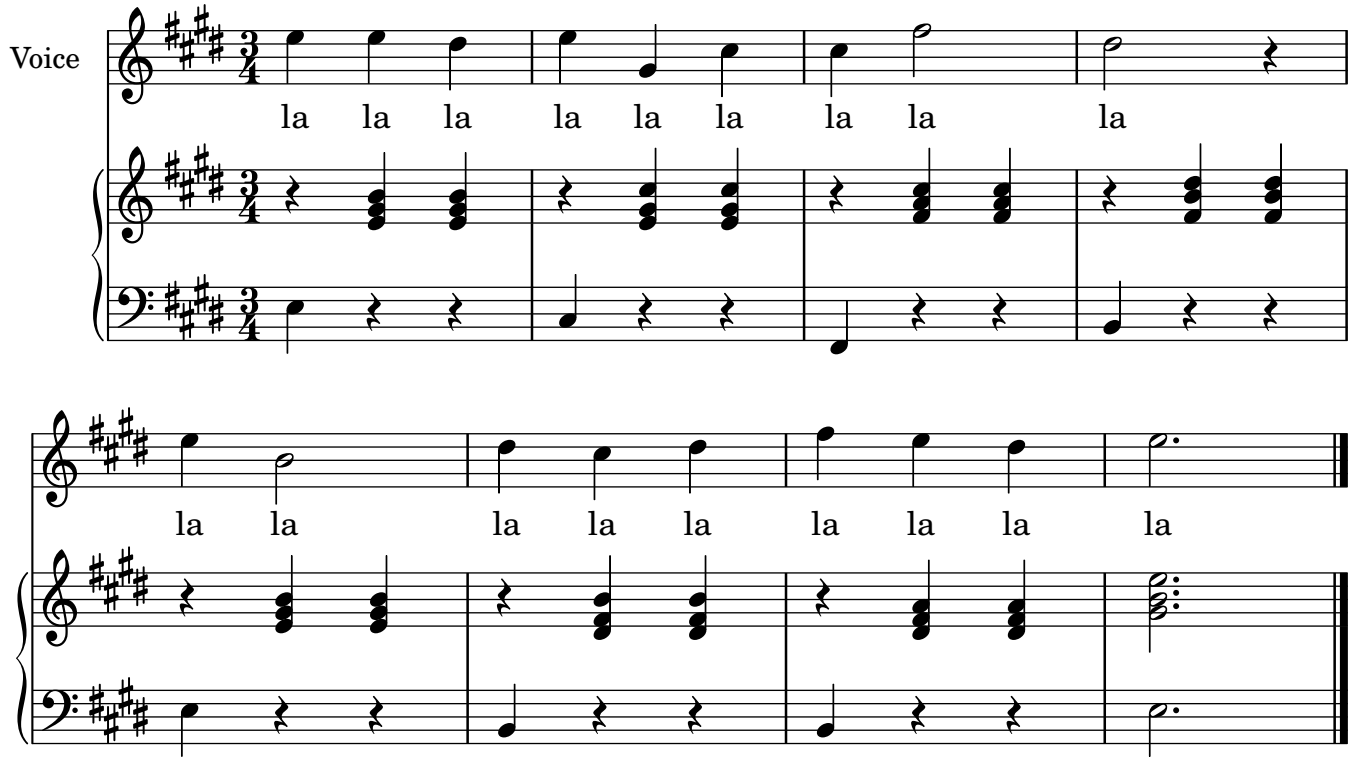
8.20 ♩ = 56



8.21 ♩ = 72



8.22 ♩ = 88



8.23



8.24 ♩ = 56



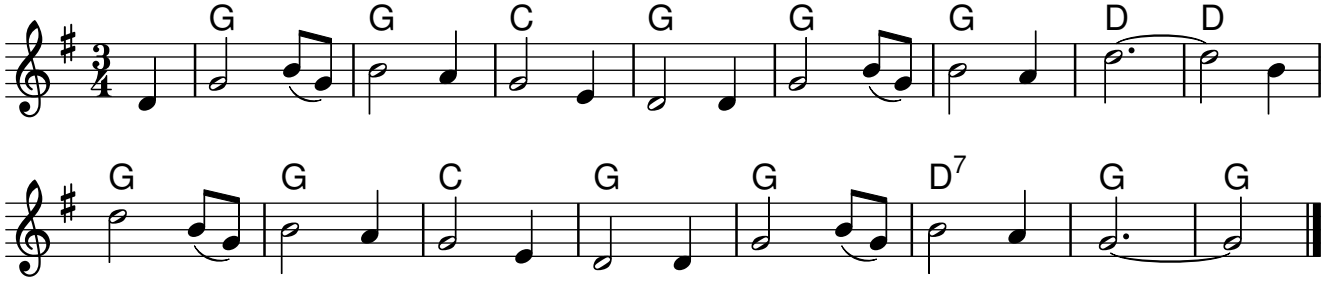
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Amazing Grace ♩ = 84

Traditional (the tune "New Britain"), a lead sheet

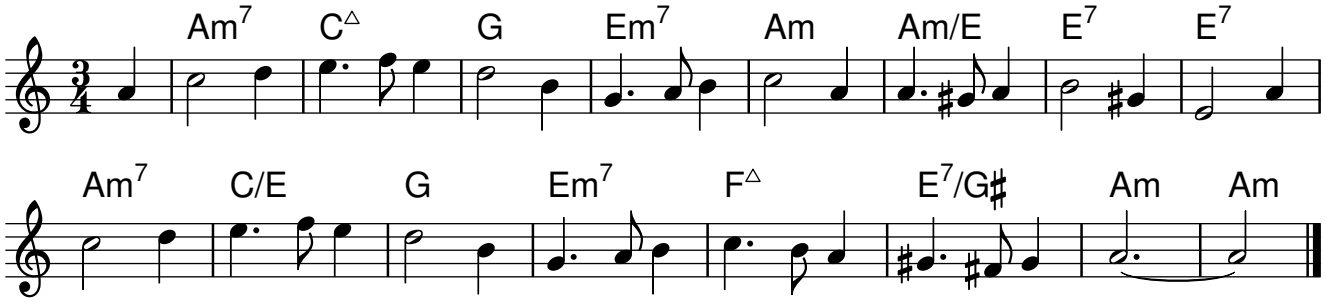
A lead sheet: the tune and the chord symbols only. Play the tune with the right hand and make the accompaniment with the left: first each chord in root position, held for the bar, then a bass note and two chords (oom-pah-pah). D7 in bar 14 leads home to G.



Greensleeves ♩ = 92

Traditional English tune (16th century), a lead sheet

A lead sheet with seventh chords and slash chords. Am7 is A C E G; Cmaj7 is C E G B; E7/G-sharp has G-sharp in the bass. Choose an accompaniment (block chords, or a bass note and two chords) and keep it steady; the G-sharps in the tune belong to the E7 chords.



Old Hundredth 𝅗𝅥 = 72

Genevan Psalter (1551), the hymn tune "Old Hundredth"

Transposing at sight: play the tune as printed (G major), then a tone lower in F major (one flat), then a tone higher in A major (three sharps). Read the shape of each line, not the note names. When you can, add a bass note under each half note with the left hand.



Waltz: Bethena ♩ = 96

Scott Joplin (1905), Bethena: A Concert Waltz - the first strain, with chord symbols

Joplin's waltz, with chord symbols added above it (they are not in Joplin's score): read the harmony of each bar as a symbol, then find it in the notes. A7/E is A7 with E in the bass; C6 adds A to C major. The right hand plays the tune over held lower notes. Joplin holds the bass octaves of bars 3, 8 and 11 (with the pedal); here they are quarter notes. Source: Mutopia Project no. 463 (public domain).



Clair de lune ♩. = 44

Claude Debussy (1890-1905), Suite bergamasque: Clair de lune - bars 1-8, with a closing chord

The last piece of the course. 9/8: three slow beats of three eighths. The music floats: tied notes hide the beat, and in bar 3 two duplets (two notes in the time of three) sound against the eighths. Both hands start in the treble clef; the left hand moves to the bass clef in bar 6. Five flats, and in bar 2 a B double-flat (the white key A). Debussy asks for "con sordina" (the soft pedal); use the sustain pedal lightly at each change of harmony. Source: Mutopia Project no. 1778 (public domain).



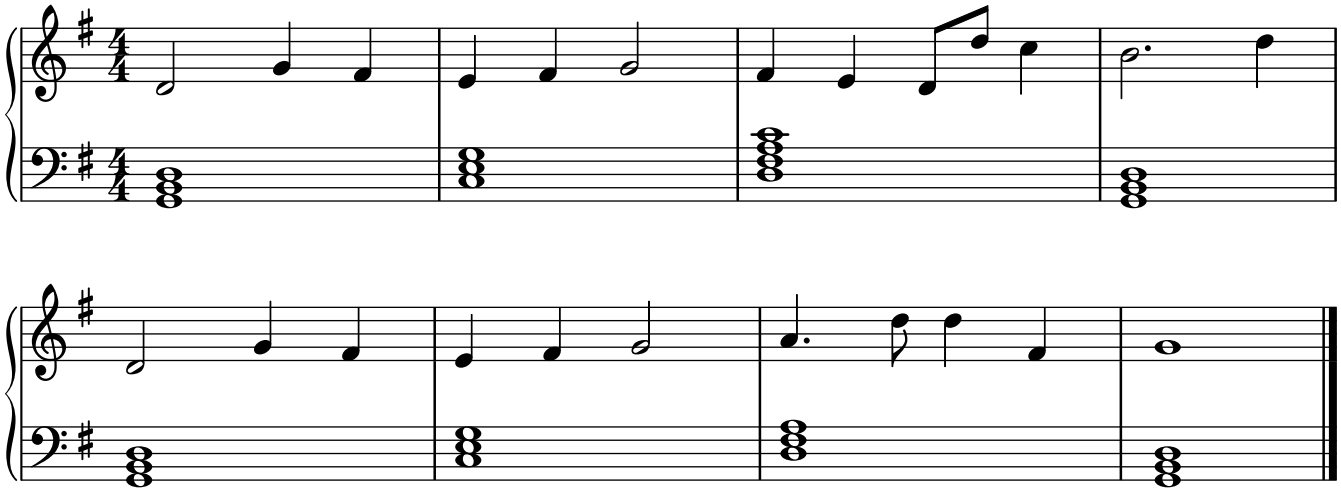
The end of the course

- Play two new exercises from each part at the speed shown, with no more than one stop each.
- Pass if you can play Amazing Grace and Greensleeves from their lead sheets with a steady left-hand accompaniment, and Old Hundredth in three keys.
- Pass if you can play the review exercises of Part C at sight, and Clair de lune after a few days.
- What next: read something new every day. Hymnals, the Bach chorales, Schubert's songs with a singer, Haydn quartets with friends, Mozart and Haydn sonatas, Chopin's mazurkas, folk-song books and lead sheets. You are a sight-reader now: keep the habit.

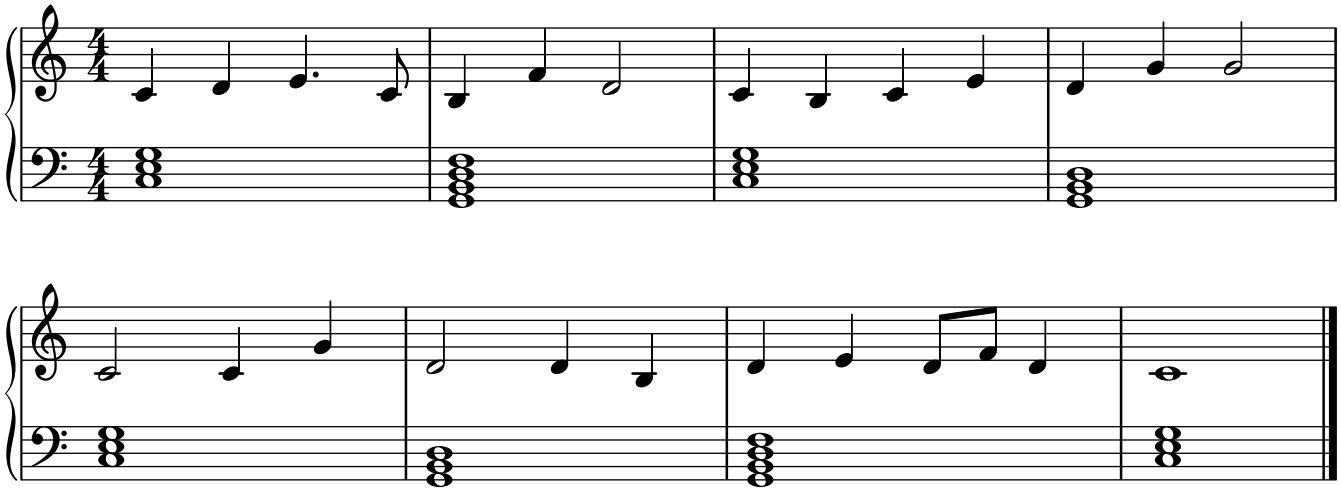
Answers

The transposing exercises, written out in their target keys. Play first; check yourself here afterwards.

☐ **7.17**



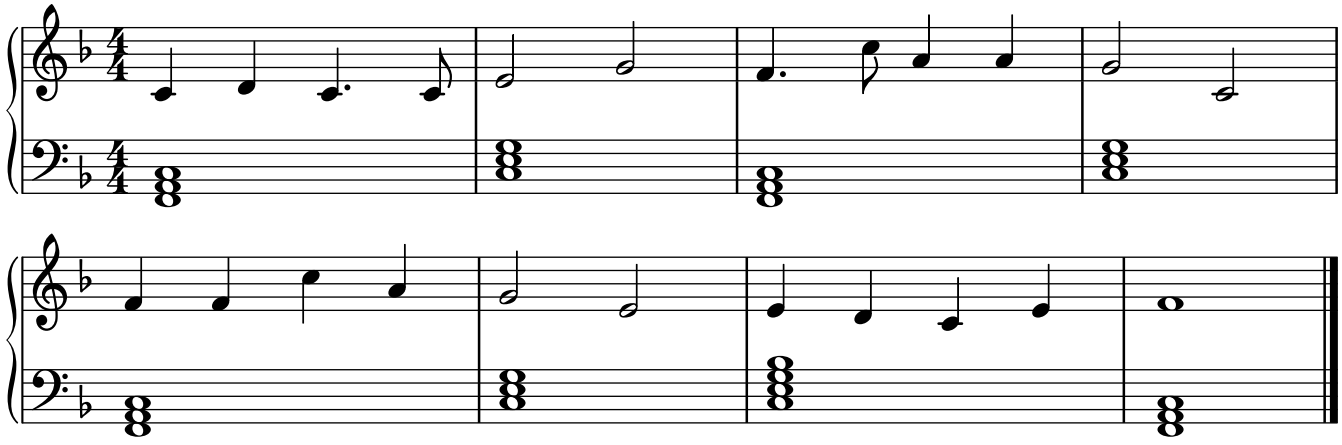
☐ **7.18**



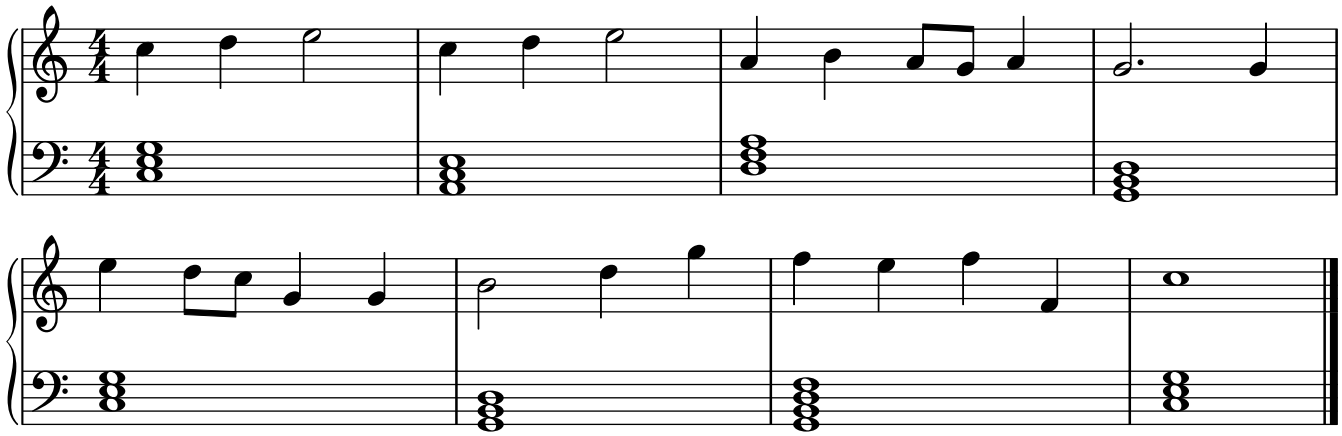
☐ **7.19**



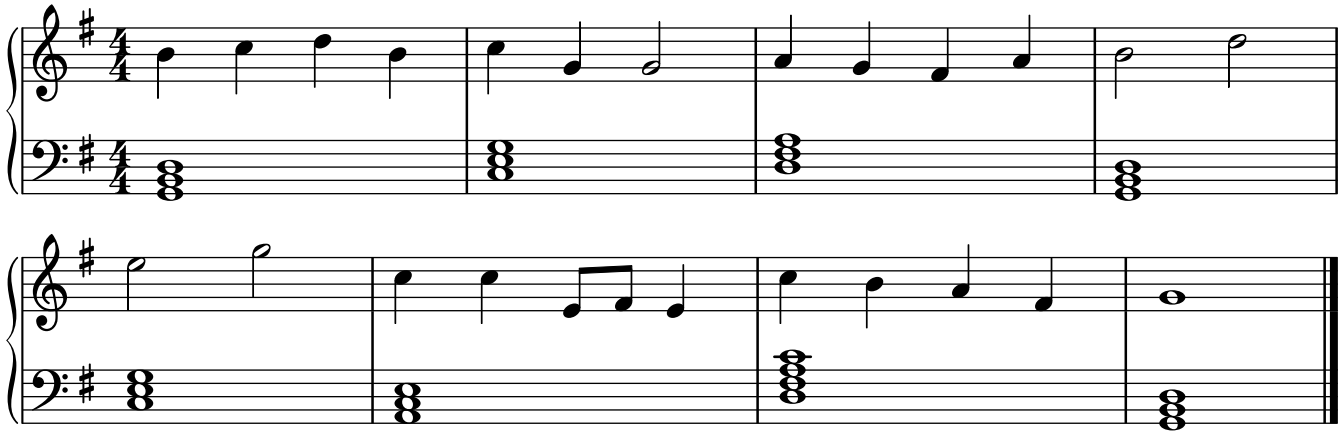
☐ **7.20**



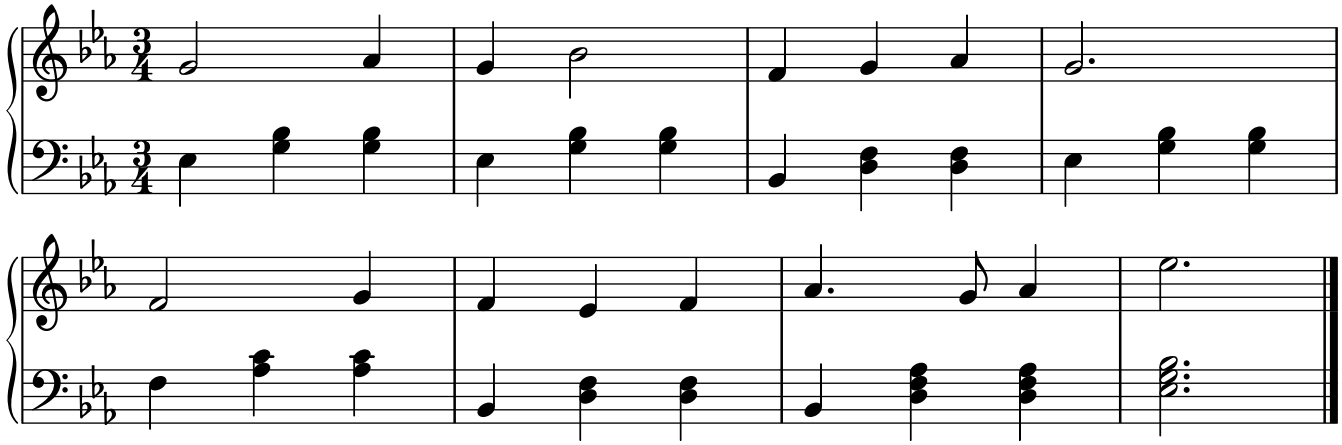
☐ **7.21**



☐ **7.22**



☐ **7.23**



7.24

